DBMS MINI PROJECT · LEVEL 3 · PHASE 2 SUBMISSION

ScholarMesh

Semantic Research-Notes Discovery & Study-Group Matchmaking Platform

Course	DBMS Experiential Learning — Level 3 Project
Institution	PES University, Electronic City Campus · Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Team	Darshan P Pawar — SRN PES2UG24CS143 Dhanush V Biradar — SRN PES2UG24CS155
Database option	Option 2 — SQL (PostgreSQL 17) + Vector database (pgvector)
Phase 2 scope	Phase 1 review and fixes · DML and seed data · vector search · advanced database features · Next.js application with authentication and roles · security · testing · documentation
Source code	https://github.com/Darshanpawar7/DBMS-Mini-Project

12	34	14	15	5	101
tables	indexes	triggers	functions & procedures	views (1 materialized)	passing tests

Contents

1. Problem statement and motivation
2. Objectives
3. Scope
4. Users, roles and functional requirements
5. Phase 1 review — issues found and fixed
6. Entity–relationship diagram
7. ER-to-relational mapping and relational schema
8. Database choice and justification
9. Data dictionary
10. SQL implementation
11. Vector database and semantic search
12. Advanced database features — summary
13. Important queries
14. System architecture, API and security
15. Application screenshots
16. Testing
17. Requirement coverage
18. Individual contributions and version control
19. Conclusion and future enhancements

Appendix A — Running the project

1. Problem statement and motivation

Students collect a large amount of material over a semester — lecture notes, PDFs, cheat sheets, past-paper solutions — but it ends up scattered across Drive folders, WhatsApp groups and laptops. Every one of those tools searches by *exact keywords or file names*. A student who wants "notes that explain how a model decides which words matter" finds nothing unless someone happened to use those words; the note titled *Transformers and Self-Attention Explained* stays invisible.

Finding study partners is just as ad hoc: students ask around in class groups, with no way to see who is actually working on the same topics.

ScholarMesh addresses both problems with one database design. Students upload notes; the text is split into passages and turned into *embeddings* (lists of 384 numbers that capture meaning), so a question finds notes by meaning, not by wording. The same embeddings, averaged over what each student uploads, saves and searches for, form an *interest profile* that the database uses to recommend study groups and classmates. Course enrollment and a three-level visibility rule (public / course-only / private) decide what anyone is allowed to see.

> **Why this is more than CRUD.** Retrieval is by vector similarity and full-text ranking, not `WHERE title LIKE …`; access control is enforced inside every query path by one database function; group matching combines relational facts (enrollment, membership) with vector similarity; and business rules such as seat limits and admin hand-over are enforced by triggers that also hold under concurrent requests.

2. Objectives

1. Design a normalised relational schema for users, courses, notes, tags, study groups and activity, and evolve the Phase 1 design with `ALTER` where Phase 2 needs more.
2. Store note embeddings in a vector store (pgvector) linked to the relational data with real foreign keys, and retrieve notes by cosine similarity through an HNSW index.
3. Offer three search modes — keyword (full-text), semantic (vector) and hybrid (rank fusion) — that all respect the same access-control rule.
4. Recommend study groups and partners from enrollment plus interest-vector similarity.
5. Enforce data integrity in the database itself: constraints, triggers, transactions, row locks and a least-privilege application role.
6. Provide a Next.js web application with authentication and two system roles (student, admin) that talks to the database only through a server-side API layer.
7. Verify the result with automated unit, database-integration and end-to-end tests.

3. Scope

In scope

- Registration, login, logout; roles `student` and `admin`; per-group roles `admin` / `member`
- Uploading PDF, TXT and Markdown notes (or pasted text); text extraction; chunking; embedding

Out of scope

- Scanned PDFs (OCR) and images inside documents
- Real-time chat inside study groups; notifications by e-mail

- Keyword, semantic and hybrid search with course/tag filters; search history
- Library browsing with filters, sorting and pagination; bookmarks; "more like this"
- Course enrollment; study groups (create, join, leave, manage members); recommendations
- Admin: analytics dashboard, user roles and deactivation, course catalogue, tag merging, audit log, embedding job
- Password reset by e-mail and single sign-on
- Horizontal scaling (the login rate limiter and embedding model run in one server process)
- **Verified enrollment.** Students enroll themselves, so "course-only" means "visible to anyone who enrolled in the course". In production `ENROLLMENT` would be synced from the university's student information system or protected by per-course join codes.

4. Users, roles and functional requirements

Two **system roles** are stored in `STUDENT.role` (CHECK: `student` | `admin`). Inside each study group a student additionally has a **group role** in `GROUP_MEMBERSHIP.role` (`admin` | `member`). Self-registration always creates a student; only an admin can promote someone.

ID	Requirement	Role	Implemented by
FR-1	Register, log in and log out; deactivated accounts cannot log in	All	`/api/auth/*`, bcrypt, JWT cookie
FR-2	Upload a note (PDF/TXT/MD or pasted text) with title, course, visibility and tags	Student	`POST /api/documents`, one transaction, trigger chunking
FR-3	Search by keyword, meaning or both, filtered by course and tag	Student, Admin	`fn_keyword_search`, `fn_semantic_search`, `fn_hybrid_search`
FR-4	Only see notes allowed by their visibility (public / enrolled course / own)	Student	`fn_visible_doc_ids` in every listing and search
FR-5	Browse, filter, sort and paginate the library; bookmark notes; download files	Student	`v_document_catalog`, `BOOKMARK`
FR-6	Edit or delete own notes	Owner, Admin	`PATCH/DELETE /api/documents/:id`
FR-7	Enroll in / drop courses (dropping leaves that course's groups)	Student	`ENROLLMENT`, trigger T10
FR-8	Create a group for an enrolled course; the creator becomes group admin	Student	trigger T6 + T5
FR-9	Join / leave groups; seat limit and enrollment enforced, also under concurrency	Student	`sp_join_group`, `sp_leave_group`, trigger T5 (row lock)
FR-10	Group admins promote/demote/remove members; a group never loses its last admin	Group admin	triggers T7, T8
FR-11	Recommended groups and classmates ranked by interest similarity	Student	`fn_recommend_groups`, `fn_recommend_partners`
FR-12	Dashboard: personal statistics, new notes in my courses, trending topics, recent searches	Student	`fn_student_stats`, GROUP BY/HAVING queries
FR-13	Platform analytics: totals, searches per day, popular questions, content gaps, top contributors	Admin	aggregates, window functions, `mv_course_engagement`
FR-14	Change roles, deactivate or delete users (not themselves)	Admin	`/api/admin/users/:id`, audited
FR-15	Manage courses; merge duplicate tags	Admin	`/api/admin/courses`, `sp_merge_tags`

ID	Requirement	Role	Implemented by
FR-16	See an audit trail of sensitive changes with the acting user	Admin	trigger T11 → `AUDIT_LOG`
FR-17	Re-run the embedding job and refresh analytics	Admin	`/api/admin/embeddings`, `fn_refresh_course_stats`

5. Phase 1 review — issues found and fixed

The Week-4 schema was re-checked before building on it. Each fix is marked `FIX n` in `db/01_schema.sql` or implemented through `ALTER` in `db/02_phase2_alter.sql`.

#	Issue in Phase 1	Why it matters	Fix
1	`idx_tag_name` on `TAG(tag_name)`	`UNIQUE` already builds that index, so every insert maintained two identical indexes	Removed
2	No index on the second column of composite keys (`ENROLLMENT.course_id`, `DOCUMENT_TAG.tag_id`, `BOOKMARK.doc_id`, `GROUP_MEMBERSHIP.student_id`)	"Which groups is this student in?" and "which notes have this tag?" were full table scans	Four indexes added (+ `STUDY_GROUP.created_by`)
3	`idx_document_visibility`	Only three distinct values, so the planner would never use it	Replaced by composite `(course_id, visibility)` matching the access rule, plus a partial index on public notes
4	No system role column	The brief needs at least two roles; the schema could not express an admin	`ALTER TABLE STUDENT ADD role, is_active, last_login_at`
5	`DOCUMENT.vector_id` — a free-text pointer into an external vector store	Nothing stopped it from pointing at a vector that no longer exists; one vector per document is too coarse for good retrieval	Dropped; embeddings now live in `DOC_CHUNK` (weak entity) with a real foreign key, one vector per passage
6	`STUDY_GROUP.created_by … ON DELETE CASCADE`	If the creator deleted their account, the whole group disappeared for every other member	`ON DELETE SET NULL`; a trigger hands the admin role to the longest-standing member
7	E-mail uniqueness was case-sensitive	`Ana@x.com` and `ana@x.com` could be two accounts	Unique index on `LOWER(email)` + normalising trigger
8	`max_members` never enforced; group creator not guaranteed to be a member	Groups could be overfilled; groups could exist without an admin	Triggers T5–T9 (seat limit with row lock, creator becomes admin, succession)

#	Issue in Phase 1	Why it matters	Fix
9	`TIMESTAMP` without time zone	Ambiguous instants once the server and users are in different zones	`TIMESTAMPTZ` everywhere
10	Few validation rules (only year, visibility, role CHECKs)	The brief requires validation at the database level	22 new CHECK constraints — 25 in total (e-mail format, bcrypt-only passwords, semester format, tag format, sizes …)
11	ER diagram drew the relationship attribute `semester` as a rectangle	In Chen notation rectangles are entities	Redrawn as an attribute oval (Figure 1)

6. Entity–relationship diagram

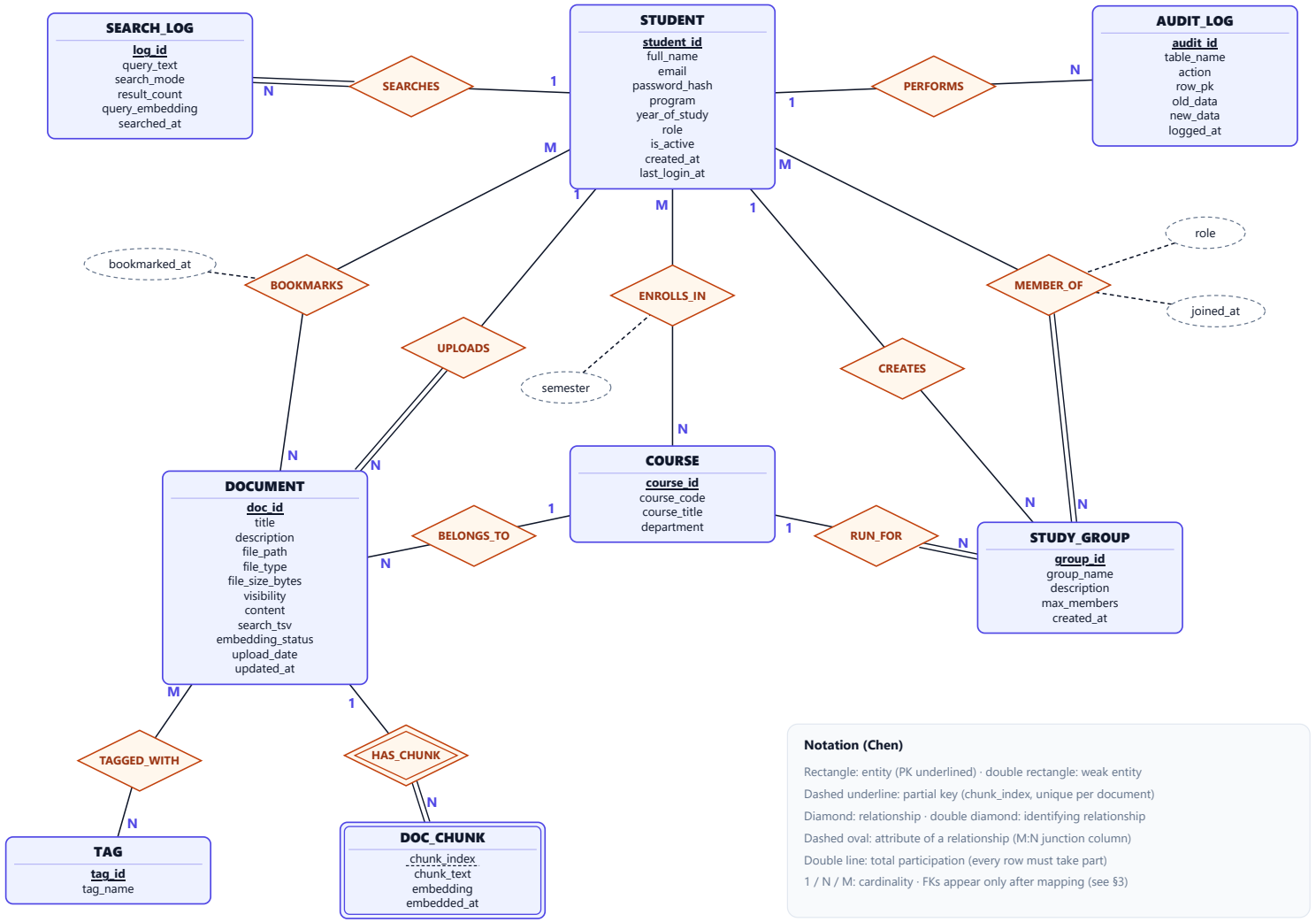


Figure 1 — Phase 2 ER diagram (Chen notation). New in Phase 2: the weak entity DOC_CHUNK with its identifying relationship HAS_CHUNK, the AUDIT_LOG entity, and new attributes on STUDENT, DOCUMENT, STUDY_GROUP and SEARCH_LOG.

Relationships and cardinalities

Relationship	Entities	Cardinality	Participation	Attributes
ENROLLS_IN	STUDENT – COURSE	M : N	partial / partial	semester
UPLOADS	STUDENT – DOCUMENT	1 : N	partial / **total**	—
BOOKMARKS	STUDENT – DOCUMENT	M : N	partial / partial	bookmarked_at
BELONGS_TO	DOCUMENT – COURSE	N : 1	partial / partial	—
TAGGED_WITH	DOCUMENT – TAG	M : N	partial / partial	—
HAS_CHUNK (identifying)	DOCUMENT – DOC_CHUNK	1 : N	partial / **total**	—
CREATES	STUDENT – STUDY_GROUP	1 : N	partial / partial	—
RUN_FOR	STUDY_GROUP – COURSE	N : 1	**total** / partial	—
MEMBER_OF	STUDENT – STUDY_GROUP	M : N	partial / **total**	role, joined_at
SEARCHES	STUDENT – SEARCH_LOG	1 : N	partial / **total**	—
PERFORMS	STUDENT – AUDIT_LOG	1 : N	partial / partial	— (actor may be the system)

7. ER-to-relational mapping and relational schema

Mapping rules: every strong entity becomes a table with its key; a 1:N relationship puts the foreign key on the N side; every M:N relationship becomes a junction table whose primary key combines both foreign keys and which carries the relationship's attributes; the weak entity DOC_CHUNK takes its owner's key (`doc_id`) — its identity is `(doc_id, chunk_index)`, enforced as `UNIQUE`, with a surrogate `chunk_id` for convenient references.

```
STUDENT(student_id, full_name, email, password_hash, program, year_of_study, role, is_active, created_at,
last_login_at)
COURSE(course_id, course_code, course_title, department)
DOCUMENT(doc_id, title, description, file_path, file_type, file_size_bytes, visibility, content,
search_tsv,
         embedding_status, upload_date, updated_at, student_id → STUDENT, course_id → COURSE)
TAG(tag_id, tag_name)
STUDY_GROUP(group_id, group_name, description, max_members, created_at, course_id → COURSE, created_by →
STUDENT)
SEARCH_LOG(log_id, query_text, search_mode, result_count, query_embedding, searched_at, student_id →
STUDENT)
ENROLLMENT(student_id, course_id, semester)
DOCUMENT_TAG(doc_id, tag_id)
BOOKMARK(student_id, doc_id, bookmarked_at)
GROUP_MEMBERSHIP(group_id, student_id, role, joined_at)
DOC_CHUNK(chunk_id, doc_id → DOCUMENT, chunk_index, chunk_text, embedding, embedded_at)   UNIQUE(doc_id,
chunk_index)
AUDIT_LOG(audit_id, table_name, action, row_pk, actor_id → STUDENT, old_data, new_data, logged_at)
```

Underlined = primary key, italic = foreign key. Referential actions: deleting a student cascades to their documents, bookmarks, memberships and searches, but sets `STUDY_GROUP.created_by` and `AUDIT_LOG.actor_id` to NULL; deleting a course sets `DOCUMENT.course_id` to NULL (a trigger turns course-only notes private) and cascades to its enrollments and groups.

Normalisation. Every non-key attribute depends on the whole key and nothing but the key: multi-valued facts (tags, enrollments, bookmarks, memberships) live in junction tables; course details are not repeated in documents or groups. The only derived values are deliberate and maintained by the database — the generated `search_tsv` and the materialized view used for analytics — so the schema is in BCNF.

8. Database choice and justification

Data	Stored in	Why
Users, courses, enrollments, groups, memberships, bookmarks, tags, search history, audit trail	PostgreSQL tables	Highly structured with many relationships; integrity matters (a membership must reference a real student, group and enrollment); needs transactions and row locks (two students joining the last seat).
Note text and its full-text index	PostgreSQL `TEXT` + generated `tsvector` + GIN	Exact-term search with stemming and ranking, kept in sync automatically by a generated column.
Passage embeddings, query embeddings	pgvector `vector(384)` + HNSW index	Notes are unstructured; meaning-based retrieval needs nearest-neighbour search over vectors, which a B-tree cannot do.

Why pgvector rather than a separate vector database

- **One query can combine both paradigms.** The access rule (enrollment, visibility, ownership) and the vector ranking run in the same SQL statement, so a private note can never "leak" through the vector store. With an external store the app would have to fetch nearest neighbours first and filter afterwards.
- **Real referential integrity.** `DOC_CHUNK.doc_id` is a foreign key with `ON DELETE CASCADE`; deleting a note deletes its vectors in the same transaction. Phase 1's string pointer could dangle.
- **Transactions span both.** Re-chunking after an edit and marking the document `pending` happen atomically.
- **Vectors become SQL values.** `AVG(embedding)` builds document centroids and student interest vectors inside views — the basis of group matching.
- **Operationally simple.** One Docker container, one backup, one connection pool.

The trade-off is scale: a dedicated vector database is better beyond tens of millions of vectors. For a university's notes (thousands of documents) PostgreSQL with HNSW answers in milliseconds.

9. Data dictionary

Generated from the PostgreSQL catalog (`information_schema` , `pg_constraint` and the `COMMENT ON` descriptions stored with the schema) by `docs/report/data-dictionary.sql` .

STUDENT

Registered user. role = student | admin (platform moderator).

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
`student_id`	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
`full_name`	varchar(100)	NOT NULL			Display name; trimmed by trigger.
`email`	varchar(120)	NOT NULL			Login id; lower-cased by trigger, unique case-insensitively.
`password_hash`	varchar(255)	NOT NULL			bcrypt hash (cost 10); CHECK rejects anything else.
`program`	varchar(80)	null			Degree programme, e.g. B.Tech CSE.
`year_of_study`	smallint	null			Year 1-6.
`created_at`	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Registration time.
`role`	varchar(10)	NOT NULL	'student'		System role: student or admin.
`is_active`	boolean	NOT NULL	true		Admins can deactivate an account without deleting its data.
`last_login_at`	timestamptz	null			Updated on every successful login.

- `chk_student_email` : `CHECK (((email)::text ~* '^[A-Z0-9._%+-]+@[A-Z0-9.-]+\.[A-Z]{2,}$'::text))`
- `chk_student_name` : `CHECK ((length(btrim((full_name)::text)) >= 2))`
- `chk_student_pwd_bcrypt` : `CHECK (((password_hash)::text ~ '^\$2[aby]\$[0-9]{2}\$[./A-Za-z0-9]{53}$'::text))`
- `chk_student_role` : `CHECK (((role)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['student'::character varying, 'admin'::character varying])::text[])))`
- `student_year_of_study_check` : `CHECK (((year_of_study >= 1) AND (year_of_study <= 6)))`

COURSE

A course offered in the programme; scopes documents, enrollments and groups.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
`course_id`	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
`course_code`	varchar(20)	NOT NULL		UQ	University course code, e.g. UE23CS351A.
`course_title`	varchar(150)	NOT NULL			Course name.
`department`	varchar(80)	null			Offering department.

- `chk_course_code` : `CHECK (((course_code)::text ~ '^[A-Z0-9-]{3,20}$'::text))`
- `chk_course_title` : `CHECK ((length(btrim((course_title)::text)) >= 3))`

DOCUMENT

An uploaded note/paper with its extracted text and access level.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
doc_id	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
title	varchar(200)	NOT NULL			Title shown in listings (search weight A).
file_path	varchar(255)	NOT NULL			Random stored file name (never the client name).
file_type	varchar(20)	NOT NULL			pdf | txt | md.
visibility	varchar(10)	NOT NULL	'private'		public = everyone, course = enrolled students, private = owner only.
upload_date	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Upload time.
student_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → STUDENT	Owner (UPLOADS).
course_id	integer	null		FK → COURSE	Course the note belongs to (BELONGS_TO); optional.
description	varchar(500)	null			One-line summary (search weight B).
content	text	null			Plain text extracted from the uploaded file.
file_size_bytes	integer	null			Size of the uploaded file, 1 B - 10 MB.
embedding_status	varchar(10)	NOT NULL	'pending'		pending until every chunk has an embedding, then ready.
updated_at	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Last edit, stamped by trigger.
search_tsv	tsvector	null	generated		Generated weighted tsvector: title (A), description (B), content (C).

- chk_document_course_vis: `CHECK ((((visibility)::text <> 'course'::text) OR (course_id IS NOT NULL)))`
- chk_document_embedding: `CHECK (((embedding_status)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['pending'::character varying, 'ready'::character varying, 'failed'::character varying])::text[])))`
- chk_document_file_size: `CHECK (((file_size_bytes IS NULL) OR ((file_size_bytes >= 1) AND (file_size_bytes <= 10485760))))`
- chk_document_file_type: `CHECK (((file_type)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['pdf'::character varying, 'txt'::character varying, 'md'::character varying])::text[])))`
- chk_document_title: `CHECK ((length(btrim((title)::text)) >= 3))`
- document_visibility_check: `CHECK (((visibility)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['public'::character varying, 'course'::character varying, 'private'::character varying])::text[])))`

TAG

Normalised topic label (lower-case, hyphenated).

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
tag_id	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
tag_name	varchar(50)	NOT NULL		UQ	Normalised label, e.g. query-optimization.

- chk_tag_name: `CHECK (((tag_name)::text ~ '^[a-z0-9][a-z0-9+#.-]{0,49}$'::text))`

STUDY_GROUP

A study group run for one course, capped at max_members.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
group_id	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
group_name	varchar(100)	NOT NULL		UQ	Unique within its course.
max_members	smallint	NOT NULL	6		Seat limit 2-20, enforced by trigger on join.
created_at	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Creation time.
course_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → COURSE, UQ	Course the group is run for (RUN_FOR).
created_by	integer	null		FK → STUDENT	Creator; NULL if the account was deleted (group survives).
description	varchar(300)	null			What the group works on.

- chk_group_max_members: CHECK (((max_members >= 2) AND (max_members <= 20)))
- chk_group_name: CHECK ((length(btrim((group_name)::text)) >= 3))

SEARCH_LOG

Every search a student runs; also an interest signal for matching.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
log_id	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
query_text	varchar(255)	NOT NULL			What the student typed.
searched_at	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Search time.
student_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → STUDENT	Who searched (SEARCHES).
search_mode	varchar(10)	NOT NULL	'hybrid'		keyword | semantic | hybrid.
result_count	integer	null			Hits returned; 0 marks a content gap.
query_embedding	vector(384)	null			Embedding of the query text; feeds the interest profile.

- chk_search_count: CHECK (((result_count IS NULL) OR (result_count >= 0)))
- chk_search_mode: CHECK (((search_mode)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['keyword'::character varying, 'semantic'::character varying, 'hybrid'::character varying])::text[])))
- chk_search_query: CHECK ((length(btrim((query_text)::text)) >= 2))

ENROLLMENT

M:N STUDENT-COURSE per semester.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
student_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → STUDENT, PK	Enrolled student.
course_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → COURSE, PK	Course taken.
semester	varchar(20)	NOT NULL		PK	Format YYYY-ODD or YYYY-EVEN.

- chk_enrollment_semester: CHECK (((semester)::text ~ '^[0-9]{4}-(ODD|EVEN)$'::text))

DOCUMENT_TAG

M:N DOCUMENT-TAG.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
doc_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → DOCUMENT, PK	Tagged document.
tag_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → TAG, PK	Applied tag.

BOOKMARK

M:N STUDENT-DOCUMENT saved items.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
student_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → STUDENT, PK	Who saved it.
doc_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → DOCUMENT, PK	Saved document.
bookmarked_at	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		When it was saved.

GROUP_MEMBERSHIP

M:N STUDENT-STUDY_GROUP with a per-group role.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
group_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → STUDY_GROUP, PK	Group joined.
student_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → STUDENT, PK	Member.
role	varchar(10)	NOT NULL	'member'		admin | member (per group).
joined_at	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Join time; oldest member inherits admin.

- group_membership_role_check : CHECK (((role)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['admin'::character varying, 'member'::character varying])::text[])))

DOC_CHUNK

Weak entity: ~800-char passage of a document plus its 384-d embedding.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
chunk_id	integer	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key (partial key is chunk_index).
doc_id	integer	NOT NULL		FK → DOCUMENT, UQ	Owning document (identifying FK).
chunk_index	integer	NOT NULL		UQ	Position of the passage inside its document.
chunk_text	text	NOT NULL			Passage text, at most 800 characters.
embedding	vector(384)	null			384-d all-MiniLM-L6-v2 sentence embedding, L2-normalised.
embedded_at	timestamptz	null			When the vector was computed.

- chk_chunk_embedded : CHECK (((embedding IS NULL) = (embedded_at IS NULL)))
- doc_chunk_chunk_index_check : CHECK ((chunk_index >= 0))
- doc_chunk_chunk_text_check : CHECK ((length(chunk_text) > 0))

AUDIT_LOG

Append-only change history written by triggers.

Column	Type	Null	Default	Key	Description
`audit_id`	bigint	NOT NULL	serial	PK	Surrogate key.
`table_name`	varchar(40)	NOT NULL			Table that changed.
`action`	varchar(10)	NOT NULL			INSERT | UPDATE | DELETE.
`row_pk`	varchar(40)	NOT NULL			Primary key of the changed row.
`actor_id`	integer	null		FK → STUDENT	User who made the change, read from the app.current_user_id setting.
`old_data`	jsonb	null			Row before the change (JSONB, secrets removed).
`new_data`	jsonb	null			Row after the change (JSONB, secrets removed).
`logged_at`	timestamptz	NOT NULL	CURRENT_TIMESTAMP		Change time.

- `audit_log_action_check` : `CHECK (((action)::text = ANY ((ARRAY['INSERT'::character varying, 'UPDATE'::character varying, 'DELETE'::character varying])::text[])))`

10. SQL implementation

The database is built by running the files in `db/` in order (`npm run db:setup`):

File	Contents
`01_schema.sql`	Phase 1 DDL, corrected: `DROP TABLE … CASCADE`, 10 `CREATE TABLE`, keys, constraints, indexes
`02_phase2_alter.sql`	`CREATE EXTENSION vector`; `ALTER TABLE … ADD COLUMN / ADD CONSTRAINT / DROP COLUMN / DROP CONSTRAINT`; new tables DOC_CHUNK and AUDIT_LOG; GIN, HNSW, partial and expression indexes; column comments
`03_views.sql`	4 views and 1 materialized view
`04_functions.sql`	12 functions and 3 procedures
`05_triggers.sql`	11 trigger functions attached as 14 triggers
`06_security.sql`	Grants for the least-privilege application role
`07–09_seed*.sql`	Demo data, inserted with `INSERT … SELECT` look-ups (no hard-coded ids)
`10_important_queries.sql`	Demonstration queries (§13)

10.1 CREATE, ALTER and DROP

```
-- Phase 2 evolves the Phase 1 tables instead of re-creating them
CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS vector;
ALTER TABLE STUDENT
    ADD COLUMN role VARCHAR(10) NOT NULL DEFAULT 'student',
    ADD COLUMN is_active BOOLEAN NOT NULL DEFAULT TRUE,
    ADD CONSTRAINT chk_student_role       CHECK (role IN ('student','admin')),
    ADD CONSTRAINT chk_student_pwd_bcrypt CHECK (password_hash ~ '^\$2[aby]\$[0-9]{2}\$[./A-Za-z0-9]{53}$');
ALTER TABLE DOCUMENT
    ADD COLUMN content TEXT,
    ADD COLUMN search_tsv tsvector GENERATED ALWAYS AS (
          setweight(to_tsvector('english', coalesce(title, '')), 'A')
       || setweight(to_tsvector('english', coalesce(description, '')), 'B')
       || setweight(to_tsvector('english', coalesce(content, '')), 'C')) STORED;
ALTER TABLE DOCUMENT DROP COLUMN vector_id;                          -- replaced by DOC_CHUNK
ALTER TABLE STUDY_GROUP DROP CONSTRAINT study_group_max_members_check;  -- superseded by 2..20 rule
CREATE TABLE DOC_CHUNK (
    chunk_id    SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
    doc_id      INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES DOCUMENT(doc_id) ON DELETE CASCADE,
    chunk_index INTEGER NOT NULL CHECK (chunk_index >= 0),
    chunk_text  TEXT    NOT NULL CHECK (length(chunk_text) > 0),
    embedding   vector(384),
    embedded_at TIMESTAMPTZ,
    CONSTRAINT uq_chunk_per_doc   UNIQUE (doc_id, chunk_index),
    CONSTRAINT chk_chunk_embedded CHECK ((embedding IS NULL) = (embedded_at IS NULL)));
CREATE INDEX idx_chunk_embedding_hnsw ON DOC_CHUNK USING hnsw (embedding vector_cosine_ops);
CREATE INDEX idx_document_search_tsv  ON DOCUMENT USING GIN (search_tsv);
```

10.2 Validation and integrity inside the database

- **25 CHECK constraints**, e.g. e-mail format, *password must be a bcrypt hash* (a plain-text password is impossible to store), semester format `YYYY-ODD|EVEN`, tag format, file type and size, group size 2–20, course-only visibility needs a course.
- **Keys**: 12 primary keys (4 composite), 15 foreign keys with deliberate `CASCADE` / `SET NULL` actions, unique constraints (course code, tag name, group name per course, chunk position) and a case-insensitive

unique index on e-mail.

- **Triggers** normalise input (names, e-mails, tags) before CHECKs run and enforce cross-table rules a CHECK cannot express (§10.6).
- The API validates the same rules first (zod) for friendly field messages; the database is the final authority.

10.3 Indexes

34 indexes: B-tree (keys, foreign keys, composite), GIN for full text, HNSW for vectors, partial indexes for the public feed and the embedding work queue, and expression indexes on `LOWER(email)` and `LOWER(query_text)`. Q16 in §13 shows the planner using the B-tree, GIN and HNSW indexes.

Table	Index	Kind	Definition
audit_log	`audit_log_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(audit_id)`
audit_log	`idx_audit_logged_at`	B-tree	`(logged_at DESC)`
bookmark	`bookmark_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(student_id, doc_id)`
bookmark	`idx_bookmark_doc`	B-tree	`(doc_id)`
course	`course_course_code_key`	B-tree, unique	`(course_code)`
course	`course_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(course_id)`
doc_chunk	`doc_chunk_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(chunk_id)`
doc_chunk	`idx_chunk_embedding_hnsw`	HNSW (vector)	`(embedding vector_cosine_ops) WITH (m='16', ef_construction='64')`
doc_chunk	`uq_chunk_per_doc`	B-tree, unique	`(doc_id, chunk_index)`
document	`document_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(doc_id)`
document	`idx_document_course_visibility`	B-tree	`(course_id, visibility)`
document	`idx_document_embedding_todo`	B-tree, partial	`(doc_id) WHERE ((embedding_status)::text <> 'ready'::text)`
document	`idx_document_public_recent`	B-tree, partial	`(upload_date DESC) WHERE ((visibility)::text = 'public'::text)`
document	`idx_document_search_tsv`	GIN (full text)	`(search_tsv)`
document	`idx_document_student`	B-tree	`(student_id)`
document_tag	`document_tag_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(doc_id, tag_id)`
document_tag	`idx_document_tag_tag`	B-tree	`(tag_id)`

Table	Index	Kind	Definition
enrollment	`enrollment_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(student_id, course_id, semester)`
enrollment	`idx_enrollment_course`	B-tree	`(course_id)`
group_membership	`group_membership_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(group_id, student_id)`
group_membership	`idx_membership_student`	B-tree	`(student_id)`
mv_course_engagement	`uq_mv_course_engagement`	B-tree, unique	`(course_id)`
search_log	`idx_searchlog_query_ci`	B-tree, expression	`(lower((query_text)::text))`
search_log	`idx_searchlog_student_time`	B-tree	`(student_id, searched_at DESC)`
search_log	`idx_searchlog_time`	B-tree	`(searched_at DESC)`
search_log	`search_log_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(log_id)`
student	`student_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(student_id)`
student	`uq_student_email_ci`	B-tree, unique, expression	`(lower((email)::text))`
study_group	`idx_studygroup_course`	B-tree	`(course_id)`
study_group	`idx_studygroup_creator`	B-tree	`(created_by)`
study_group	`study_group_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(group_id)`
study_group	`uq_group_name_per_course`	B-tree, unique	`(course_id, group_name)`
tag	`tag_pkey`	B-tree, unique	`(tag_id)`
tag	`tag_tag_name_key`	B-tree, unique	`(tag_name)`

10.4 Views and materialized view

View	Purpose
`v_document_catalog`	Document + owner + course + tag array + bookmark and chunk counts (LATERAL sub-queries) — the base of every listing and search result
`v_group_overview`	Group + course + live member count and seats left (GROUP BY)
`v_doc_centroid`	One vector per document: `AVG(embedding)` over its passages
`v_student_interest`	Interest vector per student from uploads, bookmarks and recent searches (UNION ALL + AVG + FILTER)
`mv_course_engagement` (materialized)	Per-course students, notes, saves, groups and members for the admin dashboard; unique index allows `REFRESH … CONCURRENTLY` through the SECURITY DEFINER function `fn_refresh_course_stats()`

10.5 Stored functions and procedures

Routine	Kind	What it does
`fn_visible_doc_ids(student)`	SQL, set-returning	The single access rule: public, own, course-only if enrolled, everything for admins
`fn_can_view_document(student, doc)`	SQL, boolean	Point check built on the function above
`fn_search_scope(student, course, tag)`	SQL	Visible documents narrowed by the search filters
`fn_chunk_text(text, max)`	PL/pgSQL	Paragraph/sentence-aware chunking (regex split, ordinality, packing)
`fn_keyword_search`	SQL	`websearch_to_tsquery`, `ts_rank_cd`, `ts_headline` snippet with safe markers
`fn_semantic_search`	SQL	Nearest passages by `<=>`, best passage per document (`DISTINCT ON`), threshold
`fn_hybrid_search`	SQL	Reciprocal Rank Fusion of the two (window functions + FULL OUTER JOIN)
`fn_similar_documents`	SQL	"More like this" by centroid distance
`fn_recommend_groups` / `fn_recommend_partners`	SQL	Matching by interest-vector cosine + topic Jaccard
`fn_student_stats(student)`	SQL	Six dashboard counters in one round trip
`fn_refresh_course_stats()`	PL/pgSQL, SECURITY DEFINER	Refreshes the materialized view on behalf of the low-privilege app role
`sp_join_group(student, group)`	PROCEDURE	Locks the group row (`FOR UPDATE`), checks duplicates, inserts the membership
`sp_leave_group(student, group)`	PROCEDURE	Locks the group row, then deletes the membership; T7 hands over admin or deletes the empty group
`sp_merge_tags(from, into)`	PROCEDURE	Re-points documents to the surviving tag and deletes the old one, atomically

Custom error codes (`SM001` group full, `SM002` not enrolled, `SM003` last admin, `SM004` capacity below members, `SM404`, `SM409`) are mapped by the API to HTTP 409/403/404 with the database's message.

10.6 Triggers

#	Trigger	Event	Rule enforced
T1	`trg_student_normalize`	BEFORE INSERT/UPDATE · STUDENT	Trim name, lower-case e-mail
T2	`trg_tag_normalize`	BEFORE INSERT/UPDATE · TAG	"Query Tuning " → `query-tuning`
T3	`trg_document_before_write`	BEFORE INSERT/UPDATE · DOCUMENT	Stamp `updated_at`; course deleted → note becomes private; new text → `pending`
T4	`trg_document_rechunk`	AFTER INSERT/UPDATE OF content	Rebuild DOC_CHUNK rows from the text

#	Trigger	Event	Rule enforced
T5	`trg_membership_check`	BEFORE INSERT · GROUP_MEMBERSHIP	Lock the group row; refuse if full (SM001) or not enrolled (SM002)
T6	`trg_group_add_creator`	AFTER INSERT · STUDY_GROUP	Creator becomes the group admin
T7	`trg_group_admin_succession`	AFTER DELETE · GROUP_MEMBERSHIP	Promote the longest-standing member; delete an empty group
T8	`trg_group_last_admin_guard`	BEFORE UPDATE OF role	Never demote the last admin (SM003)
T9	`trg_group_capacity_guard`	BEFORE UPDATE OF max_members	Cannot shrink below the member count (SM004)
T10	`trg_enrollment_cleanup`	AFTER DELETE · ENROLLMENT	Dropping a course leaves its groups
T11	`trg_audit_student/document/course/group`	AFTER INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE	Append JSONB before/after images and the acting user to AUDIT_LOG (password and content stripped)

10.7 Transactions and concurrency

- **Upload**: `BEGIN` → insert DOCUMENT (T4 writes chunks) → upsert tags → link tags → `COMMIT`. Any failure rolls everything back and the API deletes the stored file, so no orphan rows or files remain.
- **Join a group**: `CALL sp_join_group` locks the group row with `SELECT … FOR UPDATE`. Two students racing for the last seat are serialised — one succeeds, the other receives SM001. This is proven by an automated test that opens two connections and runs both joins at the same time (§16).
- **Leaving and member changes**: `CALL sp_leave_group`, and the promote/remove endpoints, lock the same group row first. Without it, the last two members leaving at the same instant could each see the other still present and leave an empty group with no admin; with it the second leave sees the first and deletes the group (also proven by a two-connection test).
- **Audit attribution**: every write transaction runs `SELECT set_config('app.current_user_id', $1, true)`; the setting is local to the transaction, so the audit trigger always records the right user even with pooled connections.
- All writes that change several rows (admin role changes, deleting courses or users, leaving groups) run inside `withTransaction()`.

10.8 Database security

- Two logins: `postgres` (owner, used only by the setup script) and `scholarmesh_app` (used by the web app) with `SELECT/INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE` + `EXECUTE` only — it cannot create, alter or drop objects (tested: error 42501).
- `AUDIT_LOG` is append-only for the app role (`UPDATE/DELETE/TRUNCATE` revoked).
- Passwords: bcrypt (cost 10) in the app, enforced by a CHECK; all credentials come from environment files that are not committed.
- Every SQL statement in the app is parameterised (`$1, $2 …`); no SQL is built from user input.

11. Vector database and semantic search

What is embedded	(a) every **passage** of every note — the text is split by trigger T4 using `fn_chunk_text` into chunks of at most 800 characters (paragraphs kept together, long paragraphs split on sentence boundaries); (b) every **search query**, stored in `SEARCH_LOG.query_embedding` for interest profiles.
Model	`sentence-transformers/all-MiniLM-L6-v2` (ONNX, 8-bit quantised), run locally in Node.js with Transformers.js — no API key and no note text leaves the server. Mean pooling + L2 normalisation → 384-dimensional unit vectors. Chosen after comparing three 384-d models on sample questions: it gave the clearest gap between relevant and unrelated notes.
Storage	`DOC_CHUNK.embedding vector(384)` (pgvector), `NULL` until the embedding worker fills it; `DOCUMENT.embedding_status` tracks `pending → ready` (or `failed`).
Index	`HNSW (embedding vector_cosine_ops) WITH (m = 16, ef_construction = 64)` — a navigable graph that finds approximate nearest neighbours without scanning every vector (EXPLAIN in §13, Q16).
Similarity metric	Cosine distance, operator `<=>`; the app reports *similarity = 1 − distance*.
Retrieval	`fn_semantic_search`: take the nearest passages among documents the student may see, keep the best passage per document, drop matches below 0.28 similarity, return the passage as the snippet.

Choosing the similarity cut-off

The threshold was measured, not guessed. Off-topic questions never scored above 0.27 while relevant notes scored 0.38+:

Question	Best similarity	Best note	Returned at 0.28?
what happens when i type a url	0.52	What Happens During a DNS Lookup	yes
how do models decide which words matter	0.51	Word Embeddings: word2vec and GloVe	yes
how to stop overfitting	0.45	Bias-Variance Trade-off and Regularization	yes
why does my table have duplicate data	0.38	Transactions, ACID … / Normalization	yes
quantum computing basics	0.27	(unrelated)	no → logged as a content gap
agile sprint planning	0.23	(unrelated)	no
photosynthesis in plants	0.19	(unrelated)	no

Hybrid search — Reciprocal Rank Fusion

Keyword search is precise for exact terms ("BCNF"); semantic search understands paraphrases. `fn_hybrid_search` runs both and merges them with **Reciprocal Rank Fusion**: `score = 1/(60 + keyword_rank) + 1/(60 + semantic_rank)` (a missing rank contributes 0). A note found by both methods rises to the top; a note

found by only one still appears. Example: "*bcnf decomposition*" returns nothing in keyword mode (no note contains "decomposition") but the normalization note in semantic and hybrid mode (Figures 5–6).

Interest profiles and study-group matching

`v_doc_centroid` averages each document's passage vectors. `v_student_interest` averages, per student, the centroids of notes they uploaded or bookmarked and the vectors of their searches from the last 120 days. A group's interest is the average of its members' interest vectors. `fn_recommend_groups` considers only groups in the student's courses that still have a seat and ranks them by

$$\text{match} = 0.7 \times \text{cosine}(\text{student interest}, \text{group interest}) + 0.3 \times \text{Jaccard}(\text{student topics}, \text{group topics})$$

where "topics" are the tags of notes each person uploaded or bookmarked *within that group's course*. `fn_recommend_partners` ranks classmates (students sharing a course) by interest similarity.

Embedding pipeline

1. Upload: one transaction inserts the `DOCUMENT`; trigger T4 writes its `DOC_CHUNK` rows (no vectors yet); tags are linked.
2. After commit the API embeds the new chunks in one batch and writes them with a single set-based `UPDATE … FROM unnest(…)`; the document becomes `ready`.
3. If the model is unavailable the note is still saved and keyword-searchable (`failed`); an admin re-runs the job later. Editing the text re-chunks it and resets it to `pending`.

12. Advanced database features — summary

Feature (brief requires ≥ 4)	Where	Used by the app for
Transactions	`withTransaction()`, procedures, savepoints in tests	Upload, joins, admin changes; race-safe seats
Views	4 views	Catalogue, group overview, centroids, interest profiles
Materialized view	`mv_course_engagement`	Admin analytics
Stored functions / procedures	12 functions, 3 procedures	Access control, all search modes, recommendations, joining/leaving groups, tag merge
Triggers	14 triggers	Chunking, seat limits, enrollment rule, admin hand-over, audit
Indexing	34 indexes (B-tree, composite, partial, expression, GIN, HNSW)	Every listing and search
Full-text search	Generated weighted `tsvector` + GIN	Keyword and hybrid search, highlighted snippets
Vector similarity search	pgvector + HNSW, cosine	Semantic/hybrid search, similar notes, matching

Feature (brief requires ≥ 4)	Where	Used by the app for
Window functions, CTEs	RANK, ROW_NUMBER, SUM OVER, COUNT OVER	Rank fusion, pagination totals, leaderboards
Semi-structured data	JSONB in AUDIT_LOG	Before/after images of changes
Role-based privileges	GRANT/REVOKE, SECURITY DEFINER	Least-privilege app login

13. Important queries

From `db/10_important_queries.sql`, executed against the seeded database; the output below is the real psql output (long results trimmed). Data changes run inside `BEGIN … ROLLBACK`.

Q1 — JOIN across four tables, GROUP BY, ORDER BY

```
SELECT d.title, s.full_name AS owner, c.course_code, COUNT(b.student_id) AS saves
FROM DOCUMENT d
JOIN STUDENT s       ON s.student_id = d.student_id
LEFT JOIN COURSE c   ON c.course_id  = d.course_id
LEFT JOIN BOOKMARK b ON b.doc_id     = d.doc_id
WHERE d.visibility = 'public'
GROUP BY d.doc_id, s.full_name, c.course_code
ORDER BY saves DESC, d.title
LIMIT 5;
```

```
+-----------------------------------------+----------------+-------------+-------+
|                  title                  |      owner     | course_code | saves |
+-----------------------------------------+----------------+-------------+-------+
| Transformers and Self-Attention Explained  | Sneha Kulkarni  | UE23CS353A  |     6 |
| Dynamic Programming Patterns               | Darshan P Pawar | UE23CS343A  |     5 |
| Bias-Variance Trade-off and Regularization | Meera Pillai    | UE23CS352A  |     4 |
| Normalization from 1NF to BCNF             | Darshan P Pawar | UE23CS351A  |     4 |
| CPU Scheduling Algorithms Compared         | Vikram Reddy    | UE23CS342A  |     3 |
+-----------------------------------------+----------------+-------------+-------+
(5 rows)
```

Q2 — GROUP BY + HAVING with aggregate functions

```
SELECT c.course_code, COUNT(d.doc_id) AS notes, ROUND(AVG(d.file_size_bytes)) AS avg_bytes,
       MIN(d.upload_date)::DATE AS first_upload, MAX(d.upload_date)::DATE AS last_upload
FROM COURSE c
JOIN DOCUMENT d ON d.course_id = c.course_id
GROUP BY c.course_code
HAVING COUNT(d.doc_id) >= 3
ORDER BY notes DESC;
```

```
+-------------+-------+-----------+--------------+-------------+
| course_code | notes | avg_bytes | first_upload | last_upload |
+-------------+-------+-----------+--------------+-------------+
| UE23CS352A  |     7 |    117329 | 2026-09-17   | 2026-10-27  |
| UE23CS351A  |     6 |      1649 | 2026-09-16   | 2026-10-18  |
| UE23CS353A  |     5 |      1528 | 2026-09-26   | 2026-10-23  |
| UE23CS342A  |     4 |      1621 | 2026-09-21   | 2026-10-16  |
| UE23CS343A  |     4 |      1496 | 2026-09-23   | 2026-10-20  |
| UE23CS341A  |     4 |      1677 | 2026-09-20   | 2026-10-19  |
| UE23MA241B  |     3 |      1410 | 2026-09-25   | 2026-10-17  |
+-------------+-------+-----------+--------------+-------------+
(7 rows)
```

Q4 — Correlated subquery with NOT EXISTS

```
SELECT c.course_code, COUNT(*) AS students_without_group
FROM ENROLLMENT e
JOIN COURSE c ON c.course_id = e.course_id
WHERE NOT EXISTS (SELECT 1
                  FROM GROUP_MEMBERSHIP m JOIN STUDY_GROUP g ON g.group_id = m.group_id
                  WHERE m.student_id = e.student_id AND g.course_id = e.course_id)
GROUP BY c.course_code
ORDER BY students_without_group DESC;
```

```
+-------------+-----------------------+
| course_code | students_without_group |
+-------------+-----------------------+
| UE23MA241B  |                     7 |
| UE23CS344A  |                     6 |
| UE23CS343A  |                     5 |
| UE23CS352A  |                     5 |
| UE23CS342A  |                     4 |
| UE23CS353A  |                     4 |
| UE23CS341A  |                     3 |
| UE23CS351A  |                     1 |
+-------------+-----------------------+
(8 rows)
```

Q5 — CTE + scalar subqueries

```
WITH uploads AS (
    SELECT s.student_id, s.full_name, COUNT(d.doc_id) AS notes
    FROM STUDENT s LEFT JOIN DOCUMENT d ON d.student_id = s.student_id
    WHERE s.role = 'student'
    GROUP BY s.student_id
)
SELECT full_name, notes, ROUND((SELECT AVG(notes) FROM uploads), 2) AS class_avg
FROM uploads
WHERE notes > (SELECT AVG(notes) FROM uploads)
ORDER BY notes DESC;
```

```
+-----------------+-------+-----------+
|    full_name    | notes | class_avg |
+-----------------+-------+-----------+
| Darshan P Pawar |     5 |      2.13 |
| Karthik Iyer    |     3 |      2.13 |
| Arjun Mehta     |     3 |      2.13 |
+-----------------+-------+-----------+
(3 rows)
```

Q6 — Window function RANK() OVER (PARTITION BY ...)

```
SELECT course_code, title, saves, course_rank
FROM (
    SELECT c.course_code, d.title, COUNT(b.student_id) AS saves,
           RANK() OVER (PARTITION BY c.course_code ORDER BY COUNT(b.student_id) DESC) AS course_rank
    FROM DOCUMENT d
    JOIN COURSE c ON c.course_id = d.course_id
    LEFT JOIN BOOKMARK b ON b.doc_id = d.doc_id
    GROUP BY c.course_code, d.doc_id
) ranked
WHERE course_rank = 1
ORDER BY saves DESC;
```

```
+-------------+-----------------------------------------------------+-------+-------------+
| course_code |                        title                        | saves | course_rank |
+-------------+-----------------------------------------------------+-------+-------------+
| UE23CS353A  | Transformers and Self-Attention Explained           |     6 |           1 |
| UE23CS343A  | Dynamic Programming Patterns                        |     5 |           1 |
| UE23CS351A  | Normalization from 1NF to BCNF                      |     4 |           1 |
| UE23CS352A  | Bias-Variance Trade-off and Regularization          |     4 |           1 |
| UE23CS341A  | TCP vs UDP and Congestion Control                   |     3 |           1 |
| UE23CS342A  | CPU Scheduling Algorithms Compared                  |     3 |           1 |
| UE23CS342A  | Virtual Memory, Paging and Page Replacement         |     3 |           1 |
| UE23MA241B  | Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors, Intuitively           |     3 |           1 |
| UE23CS344A  | Software Requirements: Functional vs Non-functional |     0 |           1 |
+-------------+-----------------------------------------------------+-------+-------------+
(9 rows)
```

Q10 — Full-text search

```
SELECT d.title, ROUND(k.rank::NUMERIC, 3) AS rank, k.snippet
FROM fn_keyword_search(:darshan, 'deadlock OR "page fault"', 5) k
JOIN DOCUMENT d USING (doc_id);
```

```
+-----------------------------------------------------+-------+-----------------------------------------------------
```

```
+-----------------------------------------+-------------+--------------+-----------+
|                  title                  | keyword_rank | semantic_rank | rrf_score |
+-----------------------------------------+-------------+--------------+-----------+
| RNNs, LSTMs and the Vanishing Gradient  |           1 |            1 |    0.0328 |
| Linear Regression and Gradient Descent  |           2 |            3 |    0.0320 |
| Backpropagation Without the Mystery     |           3 |            2 |    0.0320 |
| Transformers and Self-Attention Explained |         4 |            4 |    0.0313 |
| Convolutional Neural Networks Basics    |             |            5 |    0.0154 |
+-----------------------------------------+-------------+--------------+-----------+
(5 rows)
```

Q13 — Study-group and partner matching

```
SELECT group_name, course_code, seats_left, ROUND(similarity::NUMERIC, 3) AS similarity, shared_tags,
ROUND(match_score::NUMERIC, 3) AS match_score
FROM fn_recommend_groups(:darshan, 5);
SELECT full_name, shared_courses, ROUND(similarity::NUMERIC, 3) AS similarity FROM
fn_recommend_partners(:darshan, 5);
```

```
+-------------------------+-------------+------------+------------+-----------------------------------------------------
----------------------------------------+-------------+
|       group_name        | course_code | seats_left | similarity |                                                shared_tags
| match_score |
+-------------------------+-------------+------------+------------+-----------------------------------------------------
----------------------------------------+-------------+
| Attention Is All We Need | UE23CS353A  |          4 |      0.695 | {attention,backpropagation,gradient-descent,neural-
networks,nlp,transformers,word-embeddings} |       0.696 |
| Gradient Descenders      | UE23CS352A  |          3 |      0.661 | {classification,decision-trees,ensemble-learning,exam-
prep,overfitting,regularization}        |       0.613 |
| Kernel Trick Club        | UE23CS352A  |          2 |      0.643 | {classification,decision-trees,ensemble-learning}
|       0.540 |
+-------------------------+-------------+------------+------------+-----------------------------------------------------
----------------------------------------+-------------+
(3 rows)

+----------------+-------------------------------------------------------------+------------+
|   full_name    |                       shared_courses                        | similarity |
+----------------+-------------------------------------------------------------+------------+
| Siddharth Rao  | {UE23CS343A,UE23CS352A,UE23CS353A}                          |      0.644 |
| Meera Pillai   | {UE23CS343A,UE23CS351A,UE23CS352A,UE23CS353A,UE23MA241B} |      0.634 |
| Diya Shah      | {UE23CS343A,UE23CS351A,UE23CS352A}                          |      0.613 |
| Ishita Das     | {UE23CS351A,UE23CS352A,UE23CS353A}                          |      0.599 |
| Sneha Kulkarni | {UE23CS352A,UE23CS353A,UE23MA241B}                          |      0.584 |
+----------------+-------------------------------------------------------------+------------+
(5 rows)
```

Q14 — INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE, INSERT … SELECT inside a transaction, then ROLLBACK

```
BEGIN;
INSERT INTO TAG (tag_name) VALUES ('  Write Ahead Logging ') RETURNING tag_id, tag_name;   -- trigger
normalises the name
UPDATE DOCUMENT SET visibility = 'public' WHERE file_path = 'seed/er-model-mapping.md' RETURNING title,
visibility;
INSERT INTO DOCUMENT_TAG (doc_id, tag_id)
    SELECT d.doc_id, t.tag_id FROM DOCUMENT d, TAG t
    WHERE d.file_path = 'seed/acid-isolation-levels.md' AND t.tag_name = 'write-ahead-logging'
    RETURNING doc_id, tag_id;
DELETE FROM BOOKMARK WHERE student_id = :darshan RETURNING doc_id;
SELECT COUNT(*) AS darshan_bookmarks_inside_tx FROM BOOKMARK WHERE student_id = :darshan;
ROLLBACK;
SELECT COUNT(*) AS darshan_bookmarks_after_rollback FROM BOOKMARK WHERE student_id = :darshan;
```

```
BEGIN
+--------+--------------------+
| tag_id |      tag_name      |
+--------+--------------------+
|     79 | write-ahead-logging |
+--------+--------------------+
(1 row)

INSERT 0 1
+--------------------------------------+------------+
|                title                 | visibility |
+--------------------------------------+------------+
| ER Modelling and Mapping to Relations | public     |
+--------------------------------------+------------+
(1 row)

UPDATE 1
+--------+--------+
| doc_id | tag_id |
+--------+--------+
|      5 |     79 |
+--------+--------+
(1 row)

INSERT 0 1
+--------+
| doc_id |
+--------+
|     10 |
|     23 |
|     18 |
|      5 |
|     11 |
|     20 |
+--------+
(6 rows)

DELETE 6
+----------------------------+
| darshan_bookmarks_inside_tx |
… (trimmed)
```

Q15 — Stored procedure + trigger rejecting a full group

```
-- CALL arguments cannot be sub-queries, so look the ids up first (\gset stores them in psql variables)
SELECT student_id AS me         FROM STUDENT     WHERE email = 'darshan.pawar@scholarmesh.test' \gset
SELECT student_id AS tanvi      FROM STUDENT     WHERE email = 'tanvi.hegde@scholarmesh.test' \gset
SELECT group_id   AS open_group FROM STUDY_GROUP WHERE group_name = 'Gradient Descenders' \gset
SELECT group_id   AS full_group FROM STUDY_GROUP WHERE group_name = 'Query Optimizers' \gset
BEGIN;
CALL sp_join_group(:me, :open_group);
SELECT group_name, member_count, seats_left FROM v_group_overview WHERE group_id = :open_group;
SAVEPOINT before_full;
CALL sp_join_group(:tanvi, :full_group);   -- expected: ERROR  This study group is full (4 of 4 seats taken)
ROLLBACK TO SAVEPOINT before_full;
ROLLBACK;
```

```
BEGIN
CALL
+--------------------+--------------+------------+
|     group_name     | member_count | seats_left |
+--------------------+--------------+------------+
| Gradient Descenders |            4 |          2 |
+--------------------+--------------+------------+
(1 row)

SAVEPOINT
ERROR:  This study group is full (4 of 4 seats taken)
CONTEXT:  PL/pgSQL function fn_membership_check() line 13 at RAISE
SQL statement "INSERT INTO GROUP_MEMBERSHIP (group_id, student_id, role) VALUES (p_group, p_student, 'member')"
PL/pgSQL function sp_join_group(integer,integer) line 10 at SQL statement
ROLLBACK
ROLLBACK
```

Q16 — EXPLAIN ANALYZE — indexes in use

```
SET enable_seqscan = off;   -- the tables are tiny, so ask the planner to show the index path it would use at
scale
EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, COSTS OFF, TIMING OFF, SUMMARY OFF)
SELECT group_id FROM GROUP_MEMBERSHIP WHERE student_id = 5;
EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, COSTS OFF, TIMING OFF, SUMMARY OFF)
SELECT doc_id FROM DOCUMENT WHERE search_tsv @@ websearch_to_tsquery('english', 'deadlock');
EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, COSTS OFF, TIMING OFF, SUMMARY OFF)
SELECT chunk_id FROM DOC_CHUNK
ORDER BY embedding <=> (SELECT embedding FROM DOC_CHUNK ORDER BY chunk_id LIMIT 1)
LIMIT 5;
RESET enable_seqscan;
```

```
--- B-tree on GROUP_MEMBERSHIP(student_id): "which groups is this student in?" (Phase 1 had no index here)
SET
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                              QUERY PLAN                                 |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
| Bitmap Heap Scan on group_membership (actual rows=1 loops=1)            |
|   Recheck Cond: (student_id = 5)                                        |
|   Heap Blocks: exact=1                                                  |
|   ->  Bitmap Index Scan on idx_membership_student (actual rows=1 loops=1) |
|         Index Cond: (student_id = 5)                                    |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
(5 rows)

--- GIN on DOCUMENT.search_tsv: full-text match
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                              QUERY PLAN                                 |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
| Bitmap Heap Scan on document (actual rows=3 loops=1)                    |
|   Recheck Cond: (search_tsv @@ '''deadlock'''::tsquery)                 |
|   Heap Blocks: exact=3                                                  |
|   ->  Bitmap Index Scan on idx_document_search_tsv (actual rows=3 loops=1) |
|         Index Cond: (search_tsv @@ '''deadlock'''::tsquery)             |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
(5 rows)

--- HNSW on DOC_CHUNK.embedding: approximate nearest neighbours
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                        QUERY PLAN                                               |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------+
| Limit (actual rows=5 loops=1)                                                                   |
|   InitPlan 1                                                                                    |
|     ->  Limit (actual rows=1 loops=1)                                                           |
|           ->  Index Scan using doc_chunk_pkey on doc_chunk doc_chunk_1 (actual rows=1 loops=1) |
|   ->  Index Scan using idx_chunk_embedding_hnsw on doc_chunk (actual rows=5 loops=1)            |
|         Order By: (embedding <=> (InitPlan 1).col1)                                             |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------+
(6 rows)

RESET
```

14. System architecture

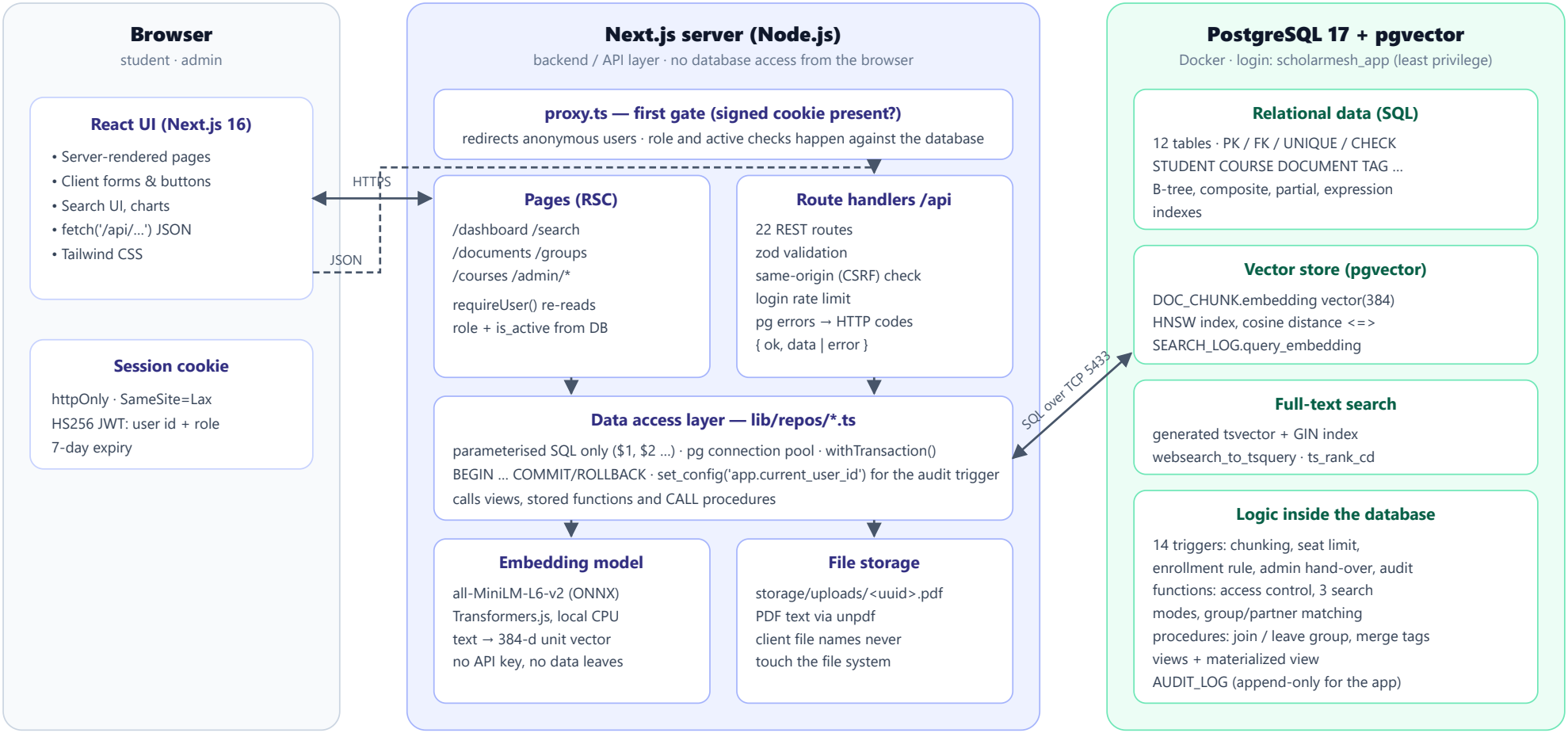


Figure 2 — Architecture. The browser never talks to the database; every read and write goes through server code that re-checks the user and uses parameterised SQL.

Request flow (example: a semantic search)

1. The browser calls `GET /api/search?q=…&mode=semantic` with the session cookie.
2. `proxy.ts` only checks that a validly signed cookie exists; the route handler re-reads the user from STUDENT (role, is_active) and validates the query with zod — so deactivation, deletion and promotion take effect immediately.
3. The server embeds the question with the local model (cached for repeated questions).
4. One SQL statement calls `fn_semantic_search`, which applies `fn_visible_doc_ids` and the HNSW index, and joins `v_document_catalog` for display fields.
5. The query and its vector are written to SEARCH_LOG (analytics and interest profile); results return as `{ ok, data }`.

API endpoints (34 handlers in 22 routes)

Endpoint	Methods	Who	Purpose
`/api/auth/register`, `/login`, `/logout`	POST	public / any	Account and session (rate-limited)
`/api/search`	GET	signed in	Keyword / semantic / hybrid search with filters
`/api/documents`	GET, POST	signed in	Library listing; multipart upload
`/api/documents/:id`	GET, PATCH, DELETE	viewer / owner / admin	Read, edit metadata, delete
`/api/documents/:id/file`, `/bookmark`	GET · POST, DELETE	viewer	Download; save / unsave
`/api/courses`, `/api/enrollments`	GET · POST, DELETE	student	Catalogue; enroll / drop
`/api/groups`, `/api/groups/:id`	GET, POST · GET, PATCH, DELETE	student / group admin	List, create, view, edit, delete groups
`/api/groups/:id/membership`	POST, DELETE	student	Join (procedure) / leave
`/api/groups/:id/members/:studentId`	PATCH, DELETE	group admin	Promote / demote / remove members
`/api/recommendations`	GET	student	Matched groups and partners
`/api/admin/stats`, `/refresh-stats`, `/embeddings`	GET · POST · POST	admin	Analytics, MV refresh, embedding job
`/api/admin/users/:id`	PATCH, DELETE	admin	Role, activation, deletion (not self)
`/api/admin/courses`, `/courses/:id`, `/tags/merge`	POST · PATCH, DELETE · POST	admin	Course catalogue; tag merge

Application security

- bcrypt password hashes; constant-cost login (a dummy hash is checked for unknown e-mails); 10 attempts per 15 minutes per account, plus per-IP limits when a trusted reverse proxy supplies the address (a client-sent `X-Forwarded-For` is never trusted).

- Session: HS256 JWT in an `httpOnly`, `SameSite=Lax` cookie (`Secure` in production); role and active flag re-read from the database on every request.
- CSRF: every POST/PATCH/DELETE must come from the same origin. XSS: React escapes output; search highlights use markers that are turned into `<mark>` elements, never injected as HTML.
- Uploads: body size checked before parsing (5 MB), extension whitelist, PDF magic-byte check, at most 150 pages and 300 000 characters, 30 uploads per hour per user, random server-side file names (no path traversal).
- Private notes never leak through aggregates: tag lists, trending topics, course note counts, interest profiles and group matching all count only notes the viewer may see. Group pages are visible only to members, students of the course and admins.
- Security headers (X-Frame-Options, nosniff, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy); generic 500 messages, details only in server logs.
- Configuration only through environment variables, validated at start-up (`DATABASE_URL`, `AUTH_SECRET` ≥ 32 chars).

15. Application screenshots

Captured automatically from the production build by `web/scripts/screenshots.ts` (Playwright, 1440 px wide).

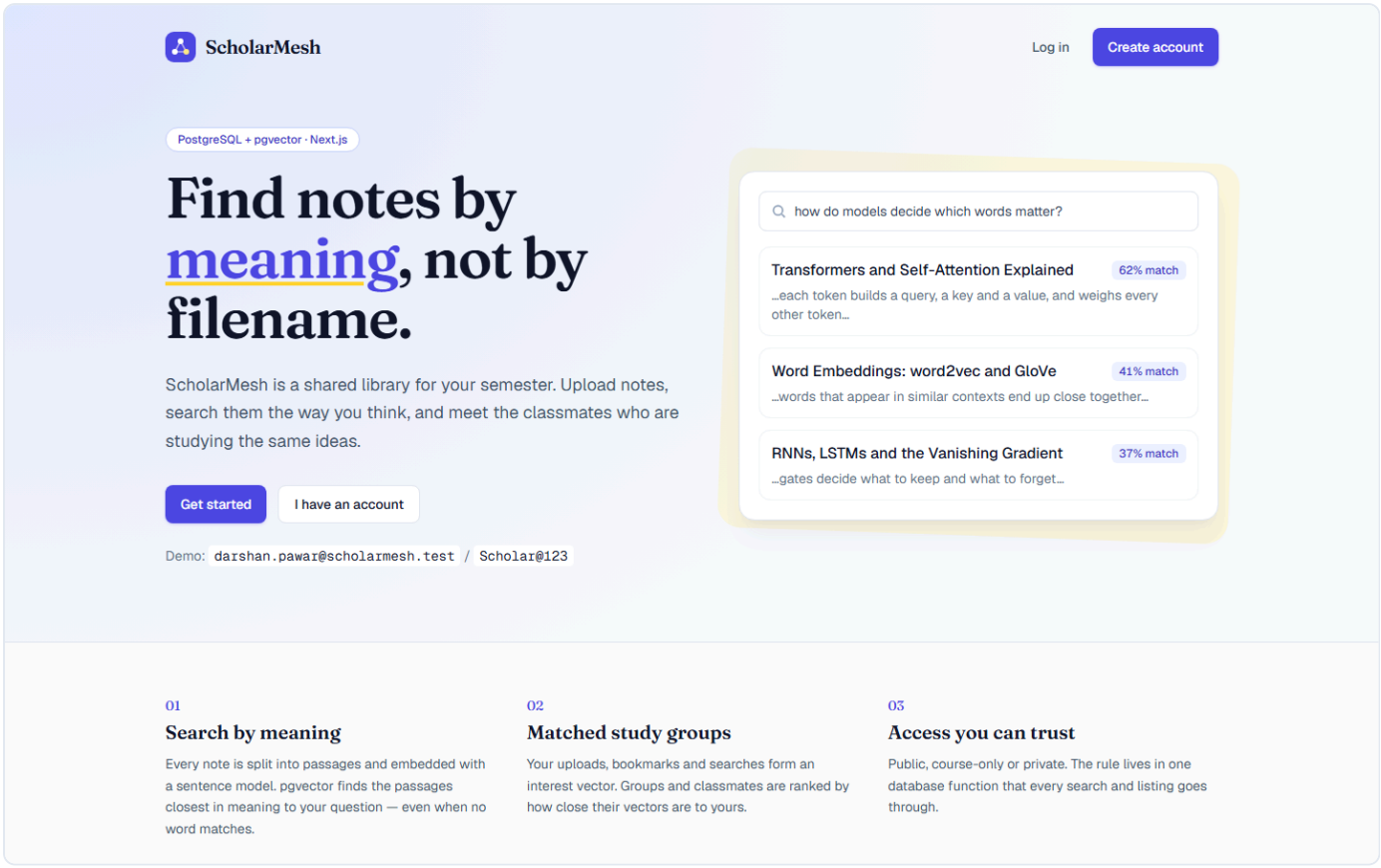


Figure 3 — Landing page (signed out)

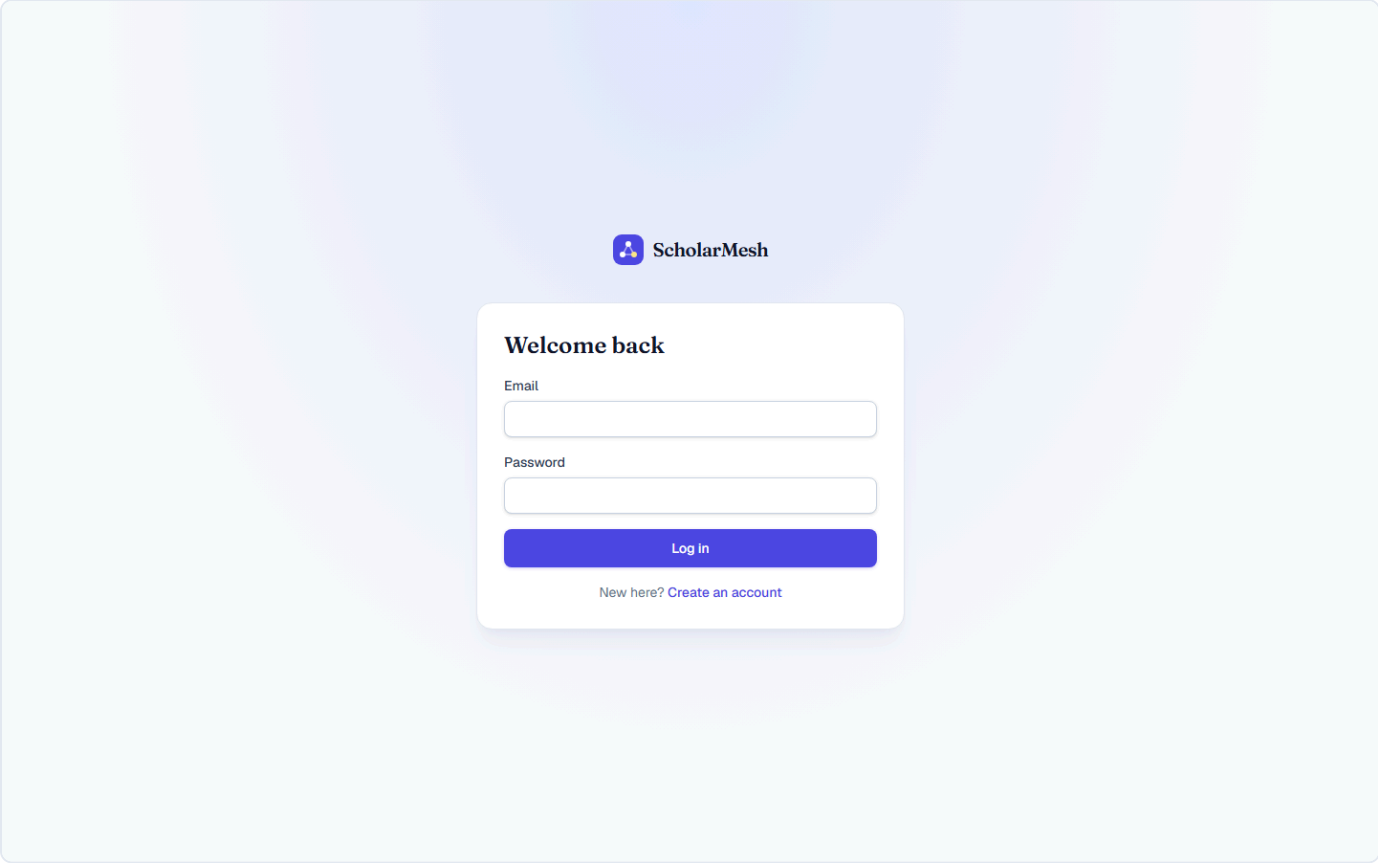


Figure 4 — Login with validation and error messages

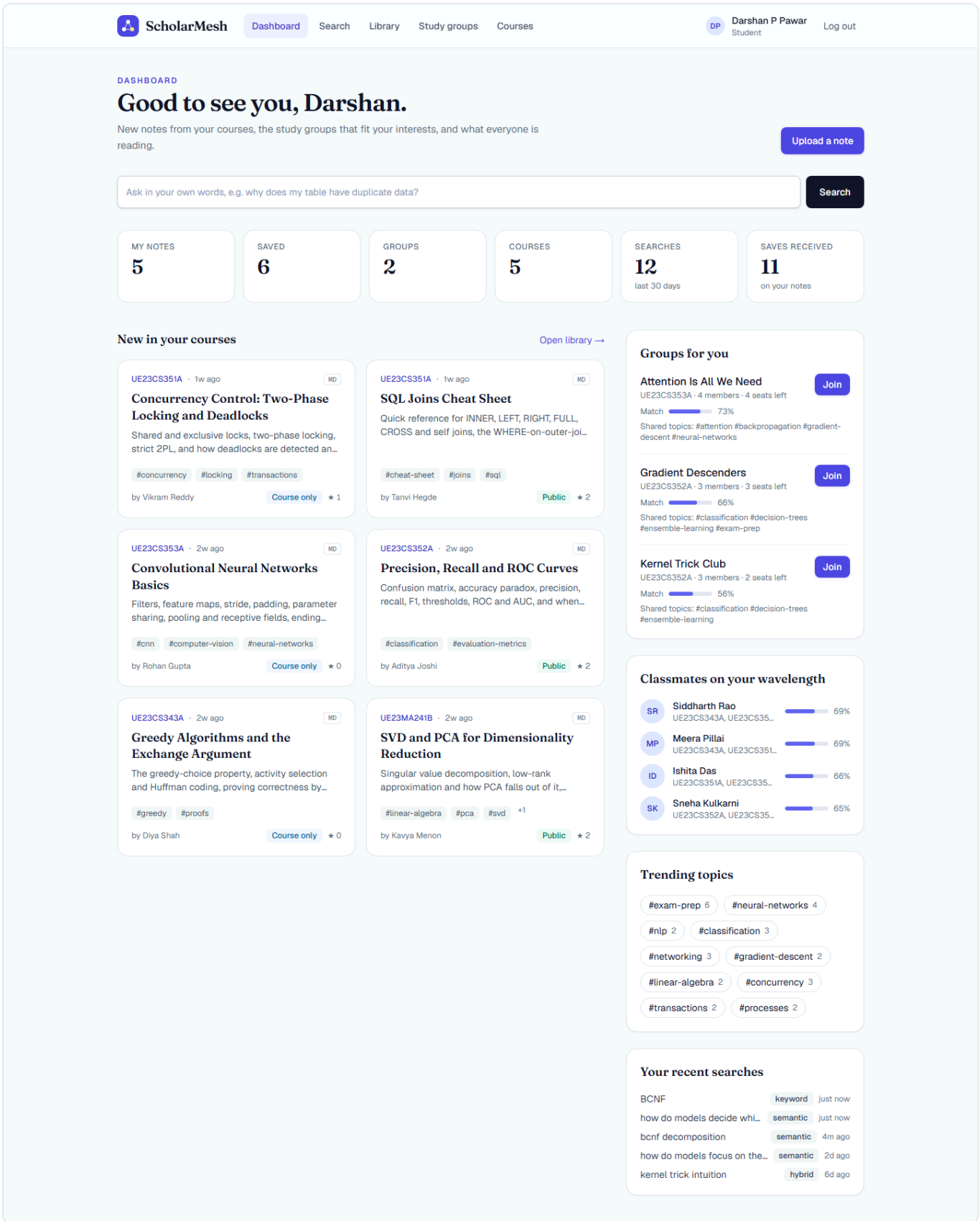


Figure 5 — Student dashboard — statistics (fn_student_stats), new notes in my courses, matched groups, classmates by interest similarity, trending topics (GROUP BY … HAVING), recent searches

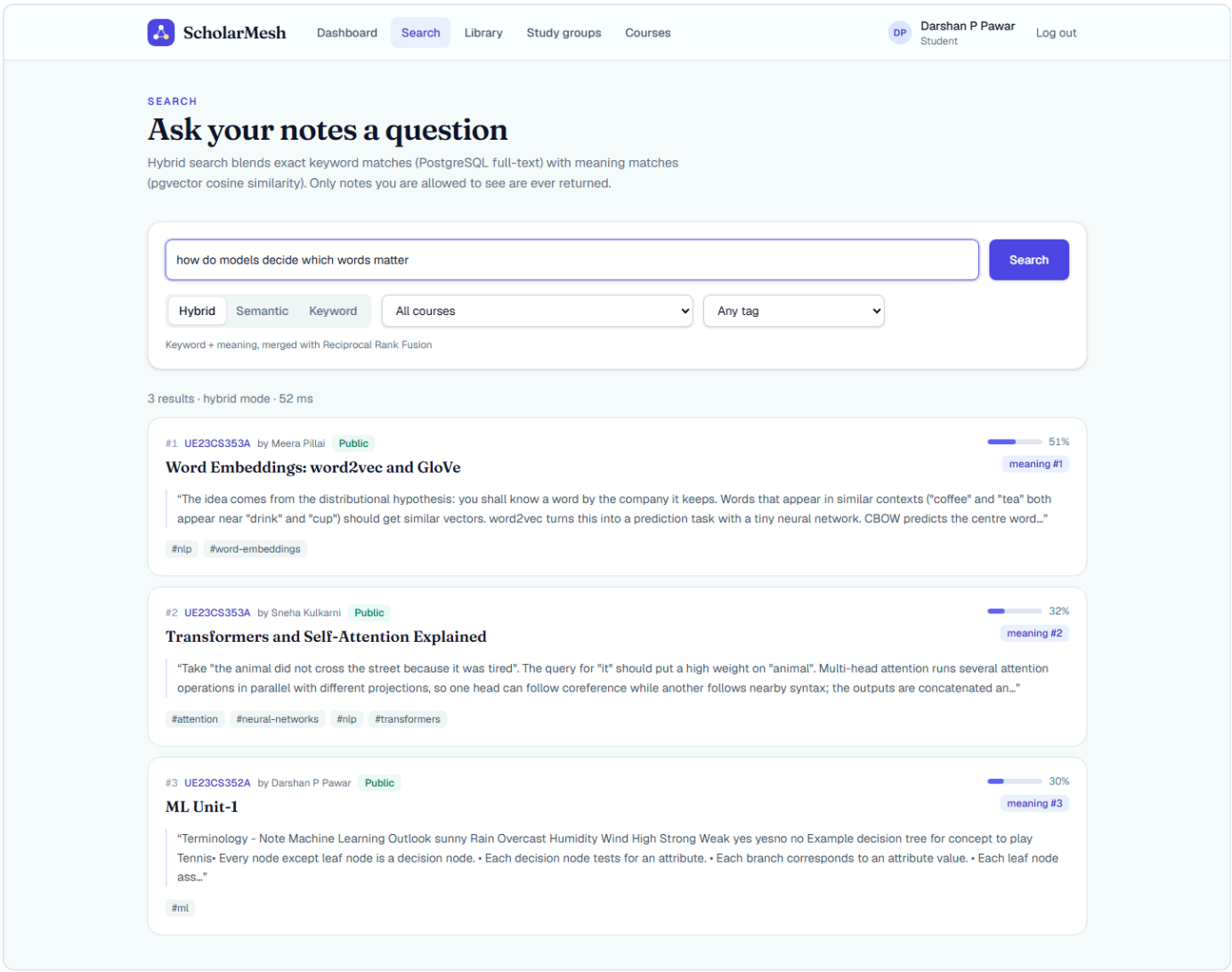


Figure 6 — Hybrid search — a question with no shared keywords; ranks from the semantic side and cosine similarity

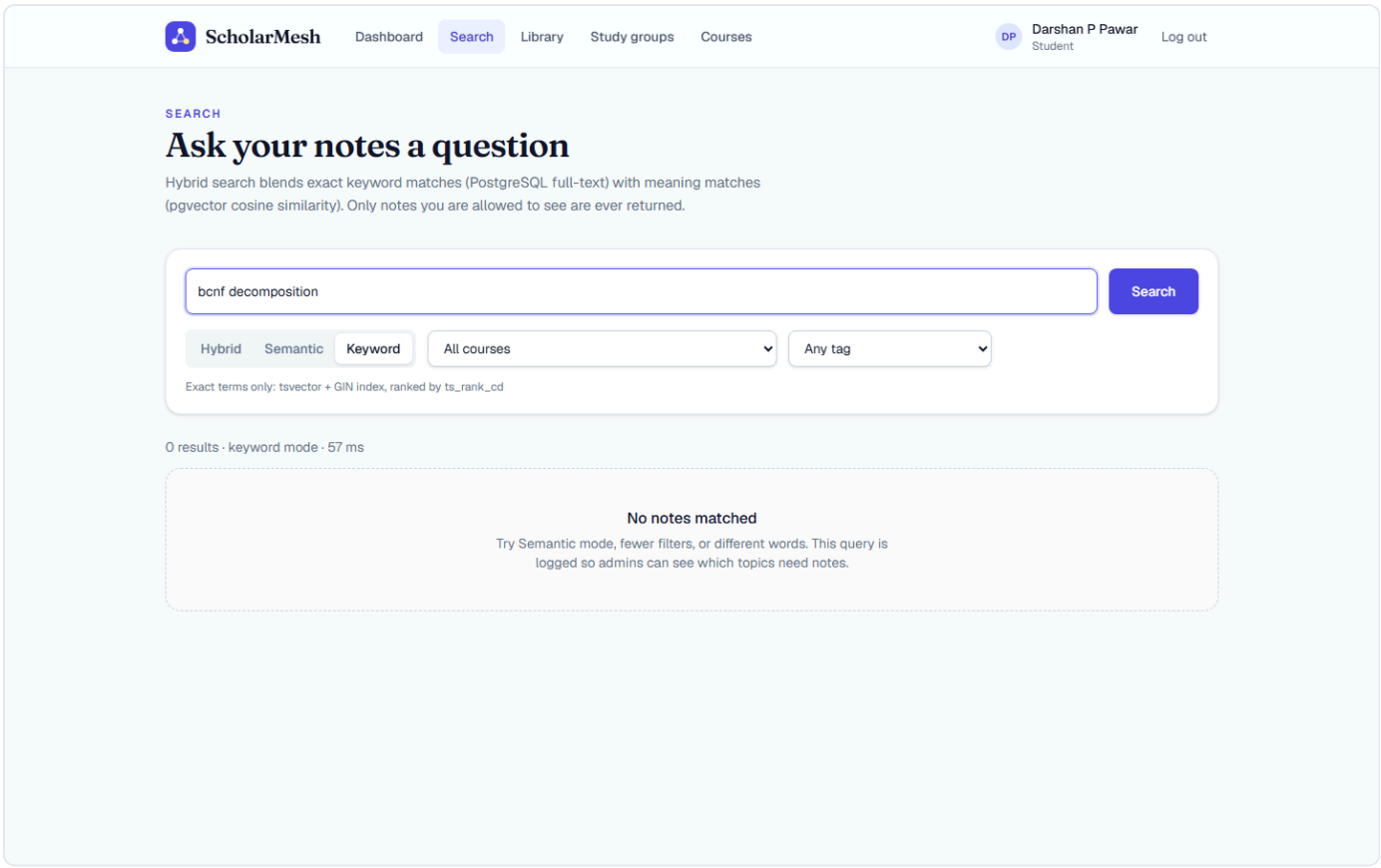


Figure 7 — Keyword mode: “bcnf decomposition” finds nothing — no note contains the word “decomposition”

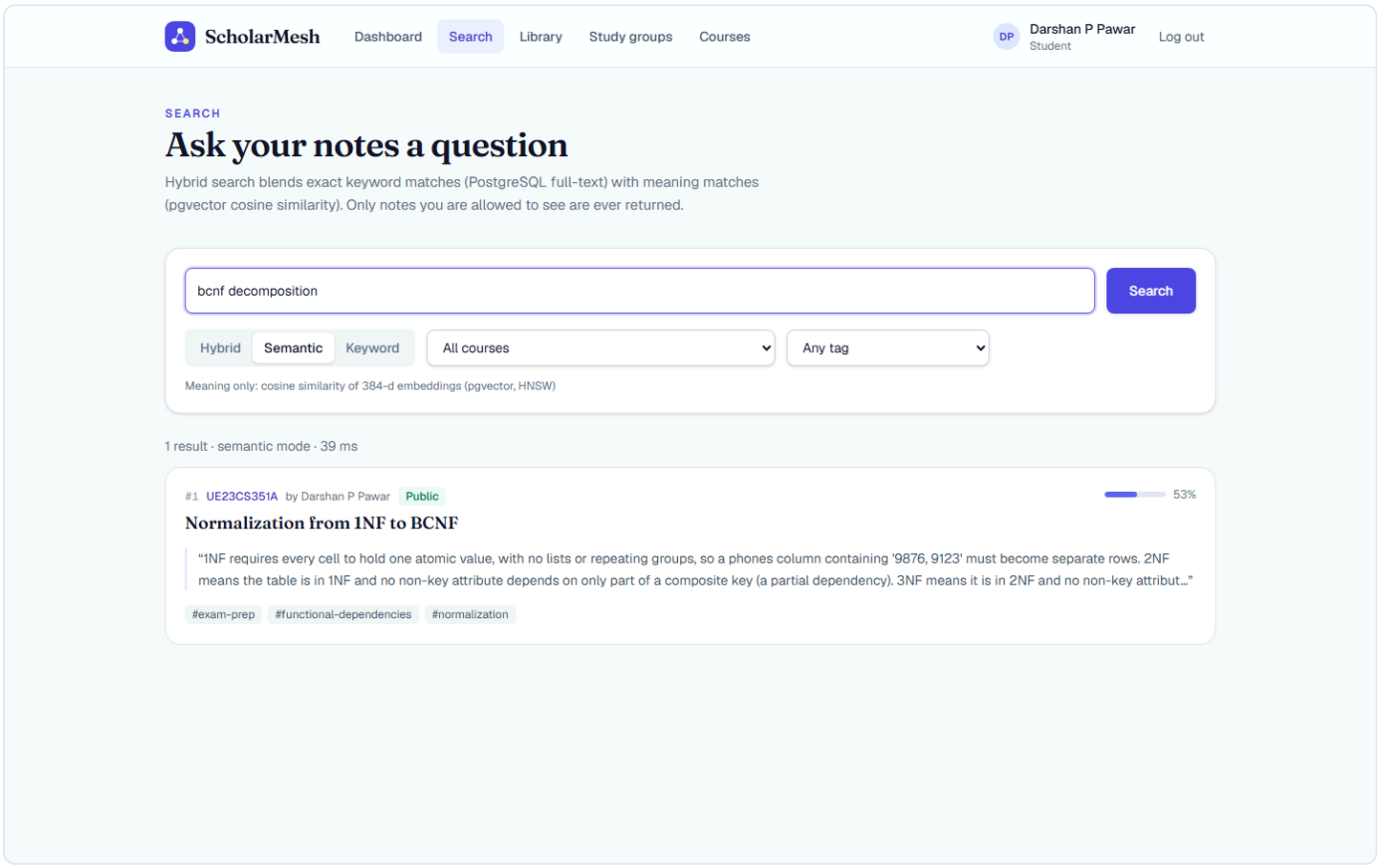


Figure 8 — Semantic mode: the same question finds the normalization note by meaning

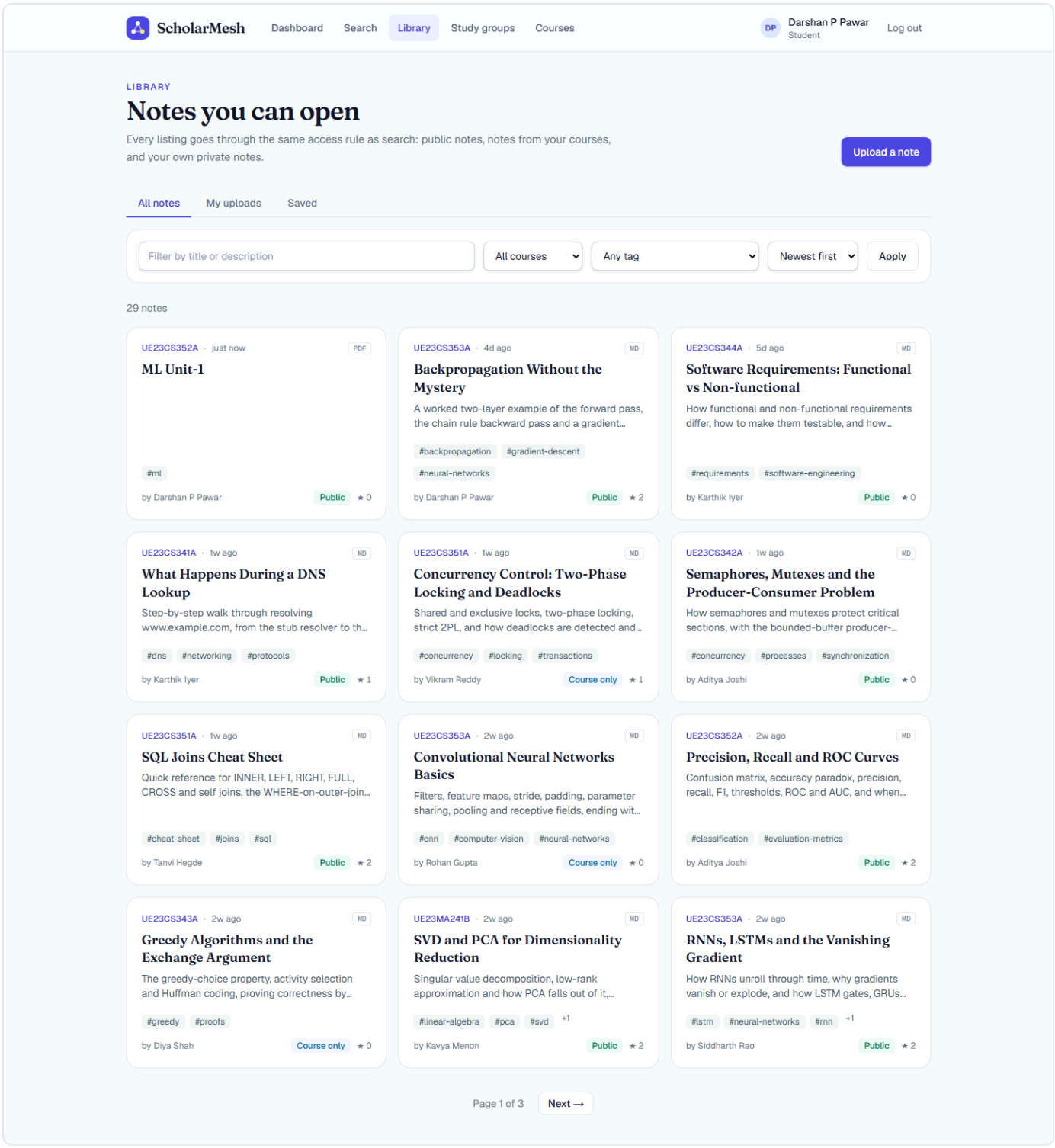


Figure 9 — Library — filters, sorting and pagination over the visible documents

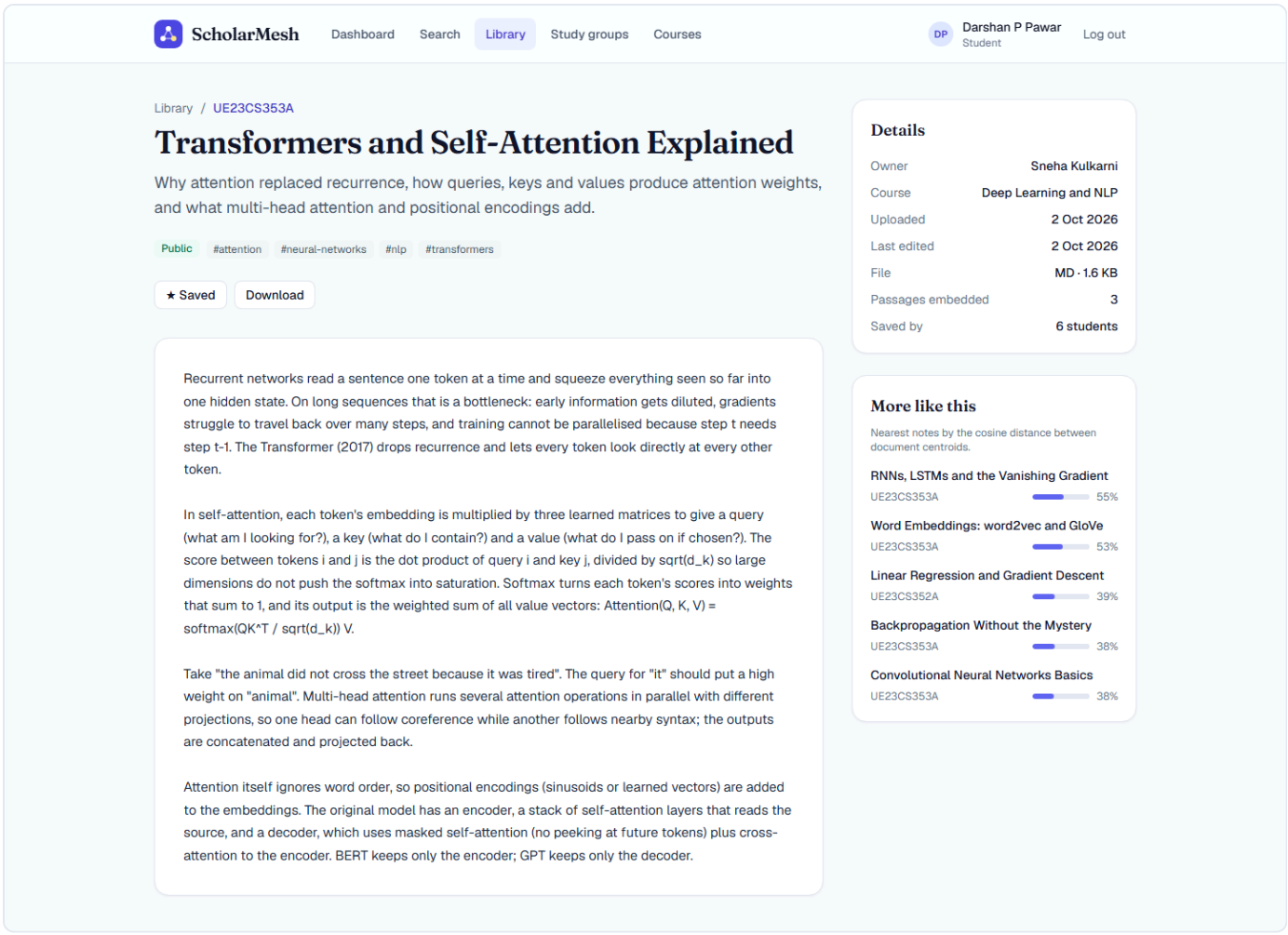


Figure 10 — Note page — metadata, passages, bookmark, download and “more like this” (centroid similarity)

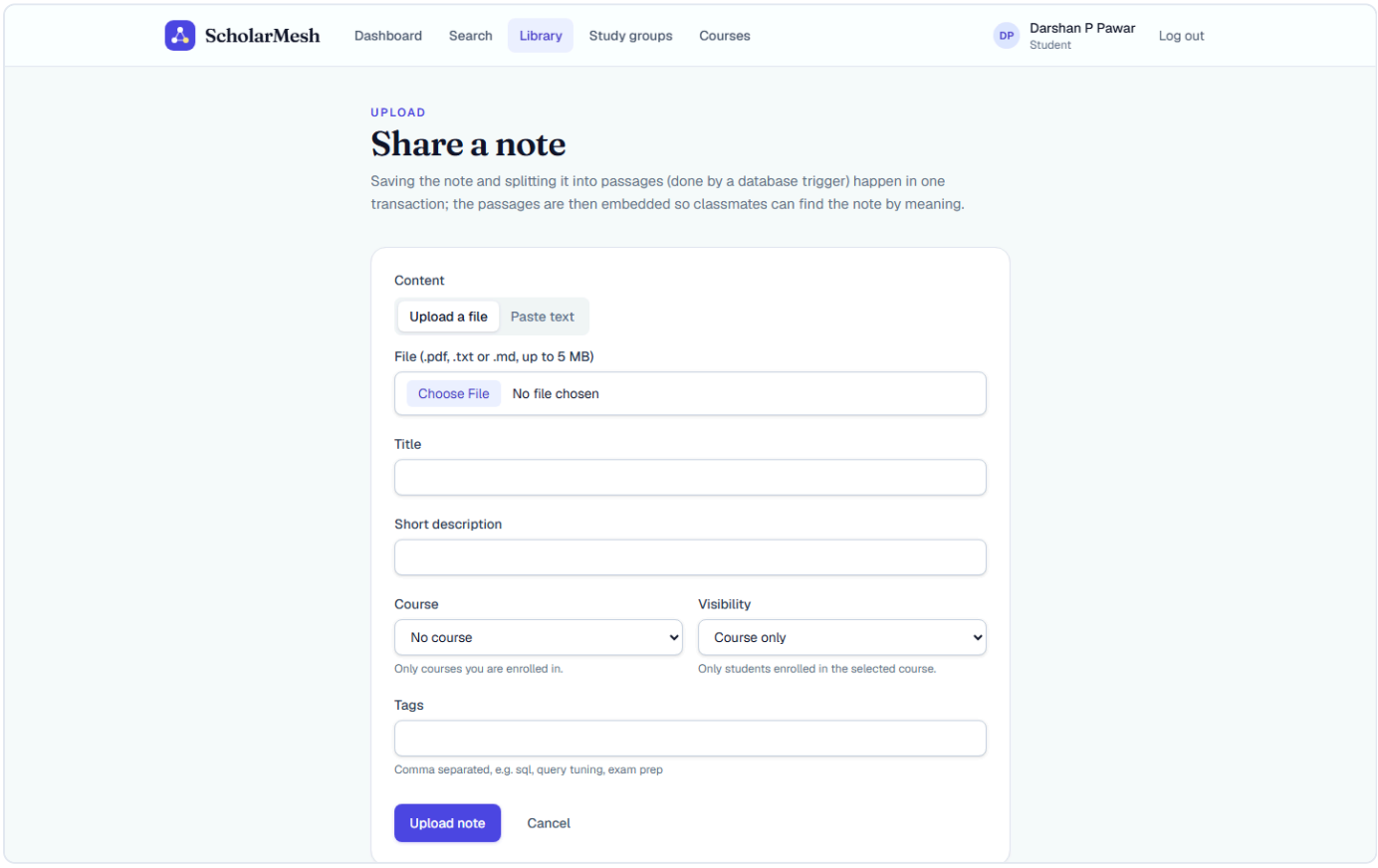


Figure 11 — Upload form — file or pasted text, course, visibility, tags

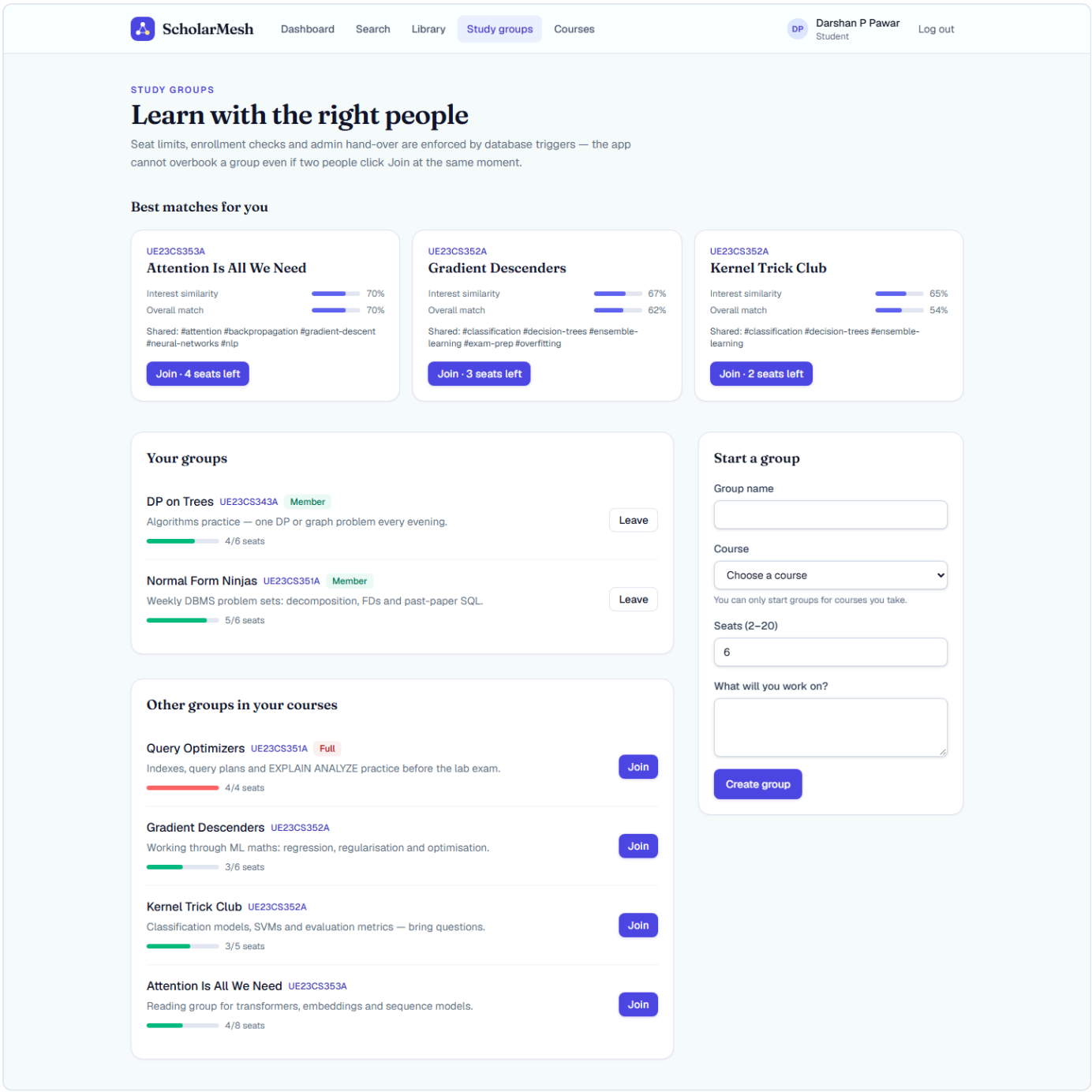


Figure 12 — Study groups — best matches, own groups, other groups with live seat counts

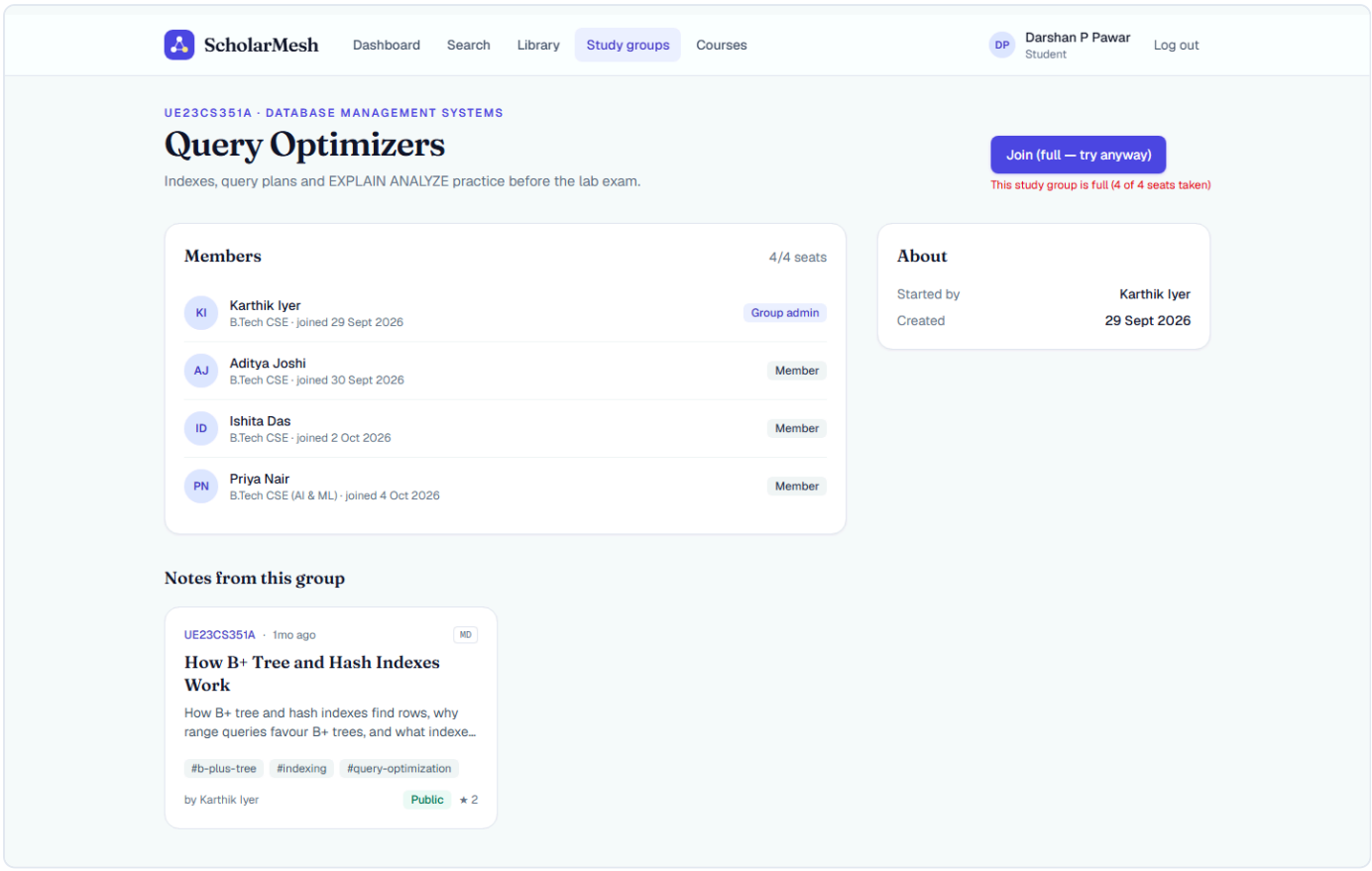


Figure 13 — Joining a full group: the database trigger refuses ("4 of 4 seats taken") and the UI shows its message

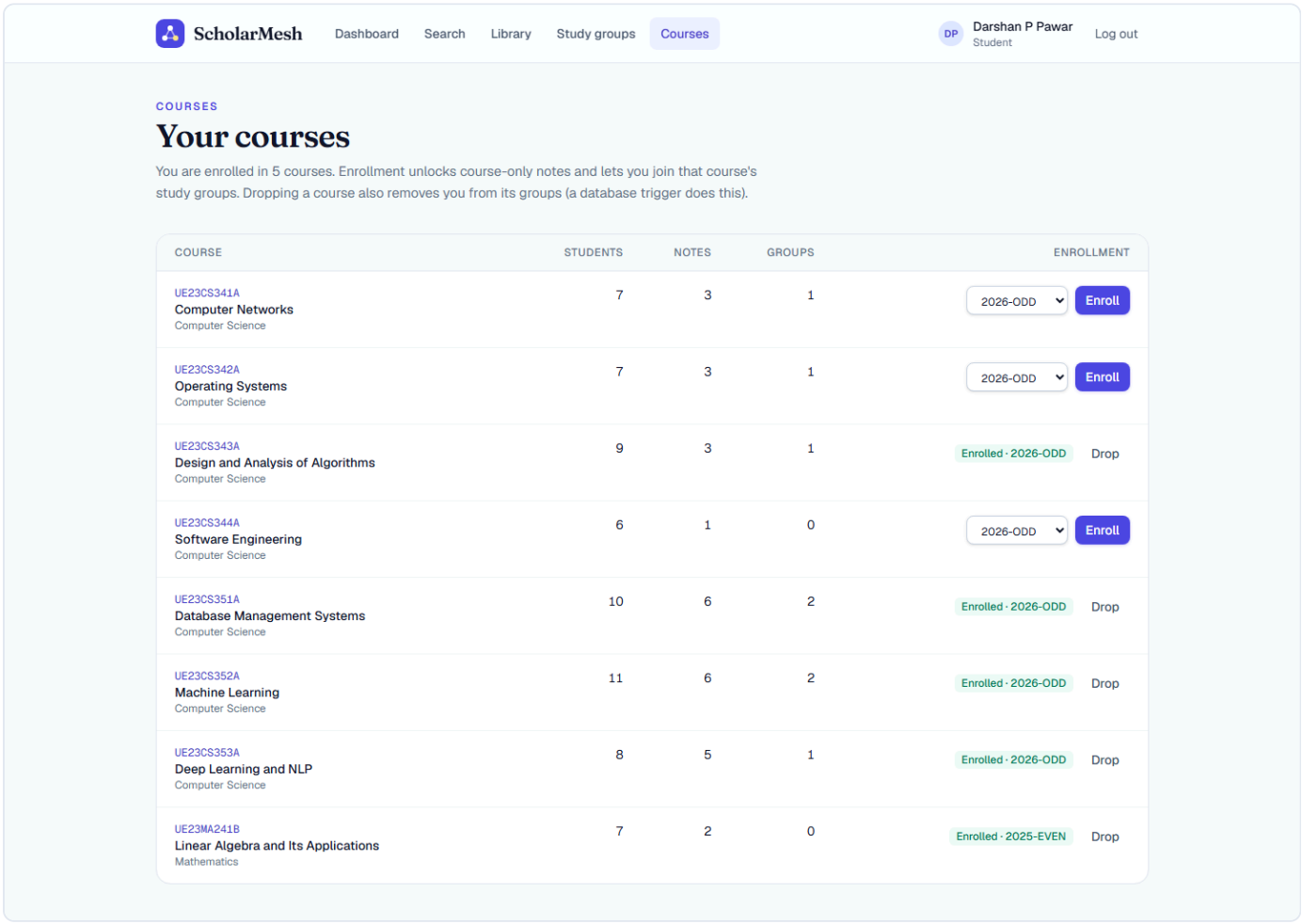


Figure 14 — Courses — enroll per semester or drop

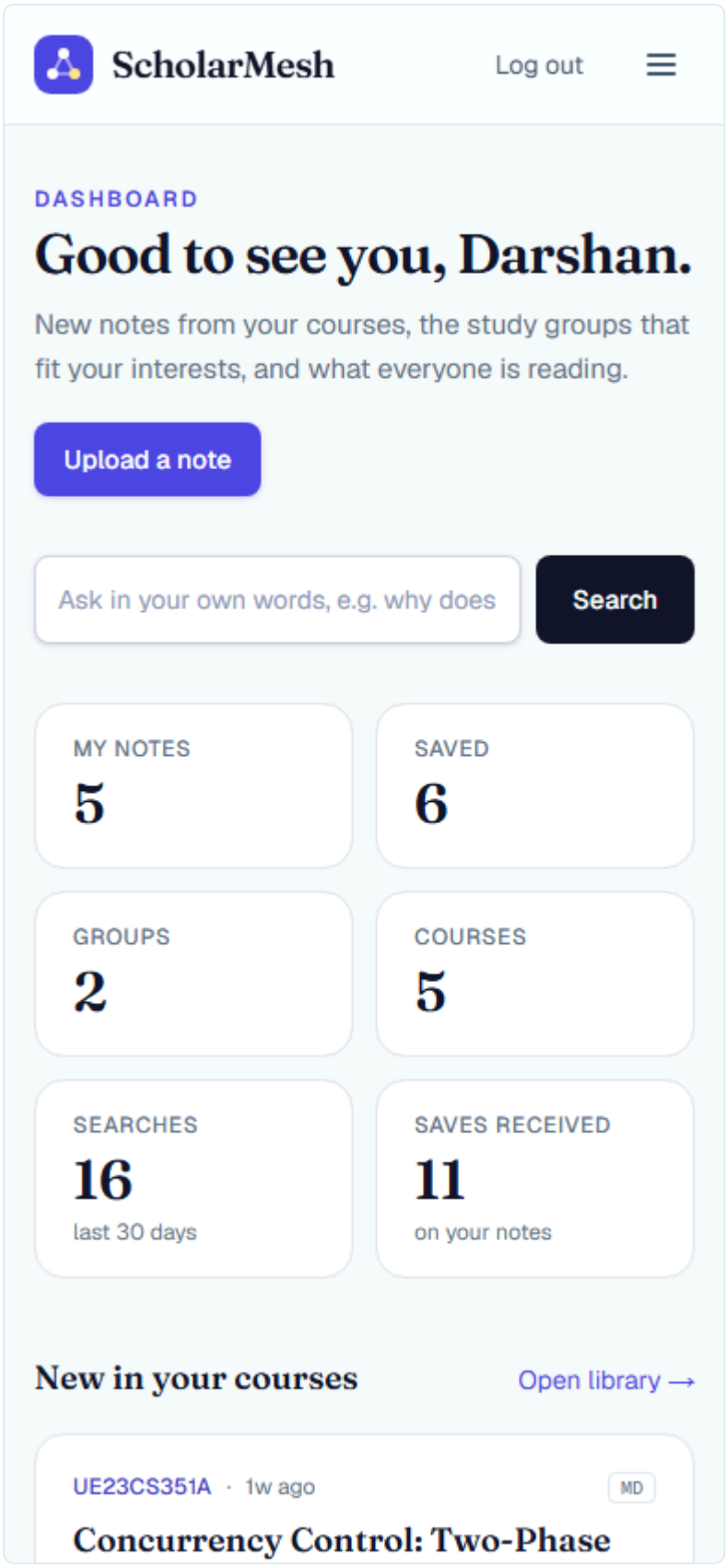


Figure 15 — Responsive layout on a 390 px phone screen

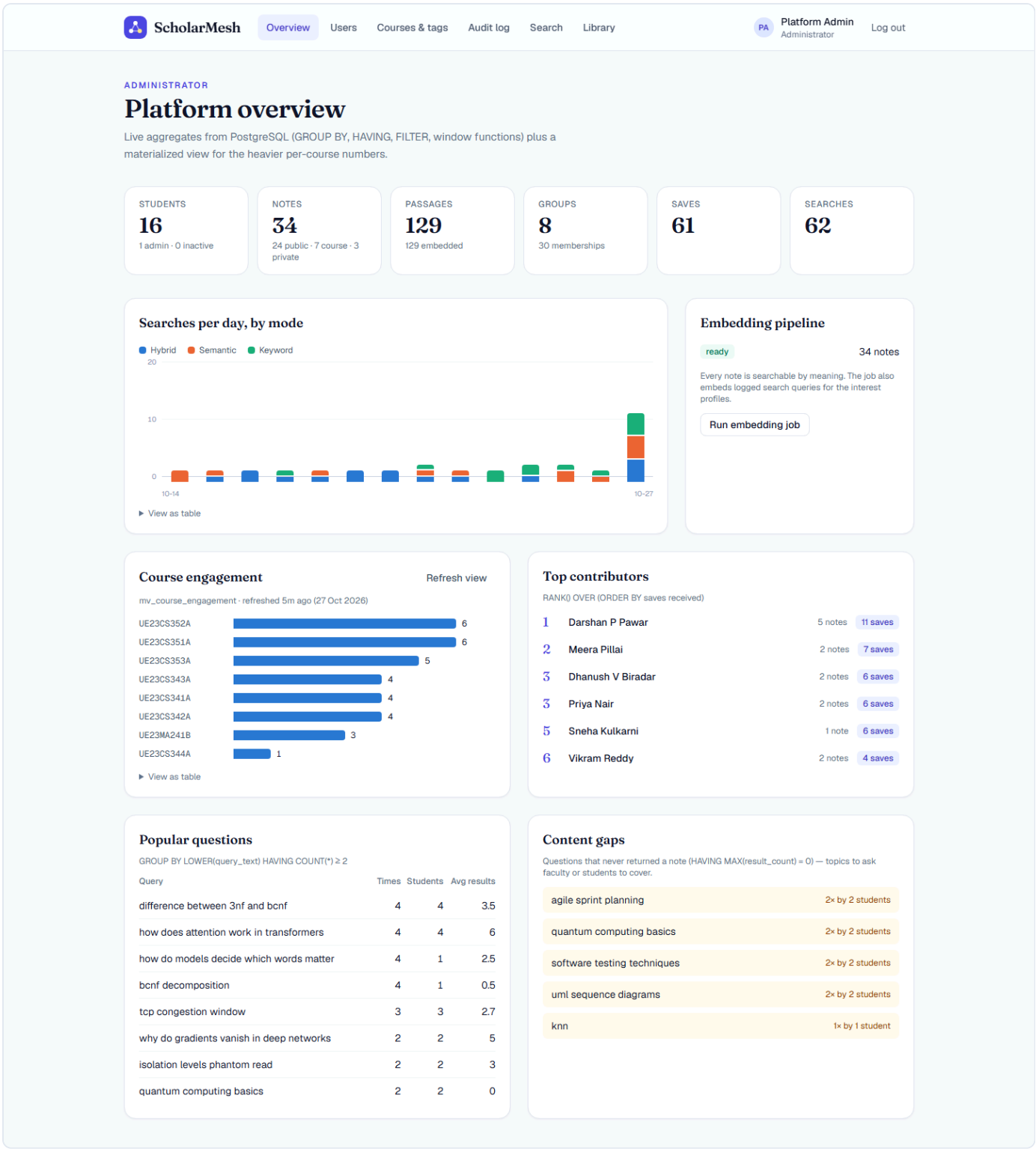


Figure 16 — Admin overview — totals, searches per day by mode, embedding pipeline, materialized-view course engagement, RANK() leaderboard, popular questions and content gaps

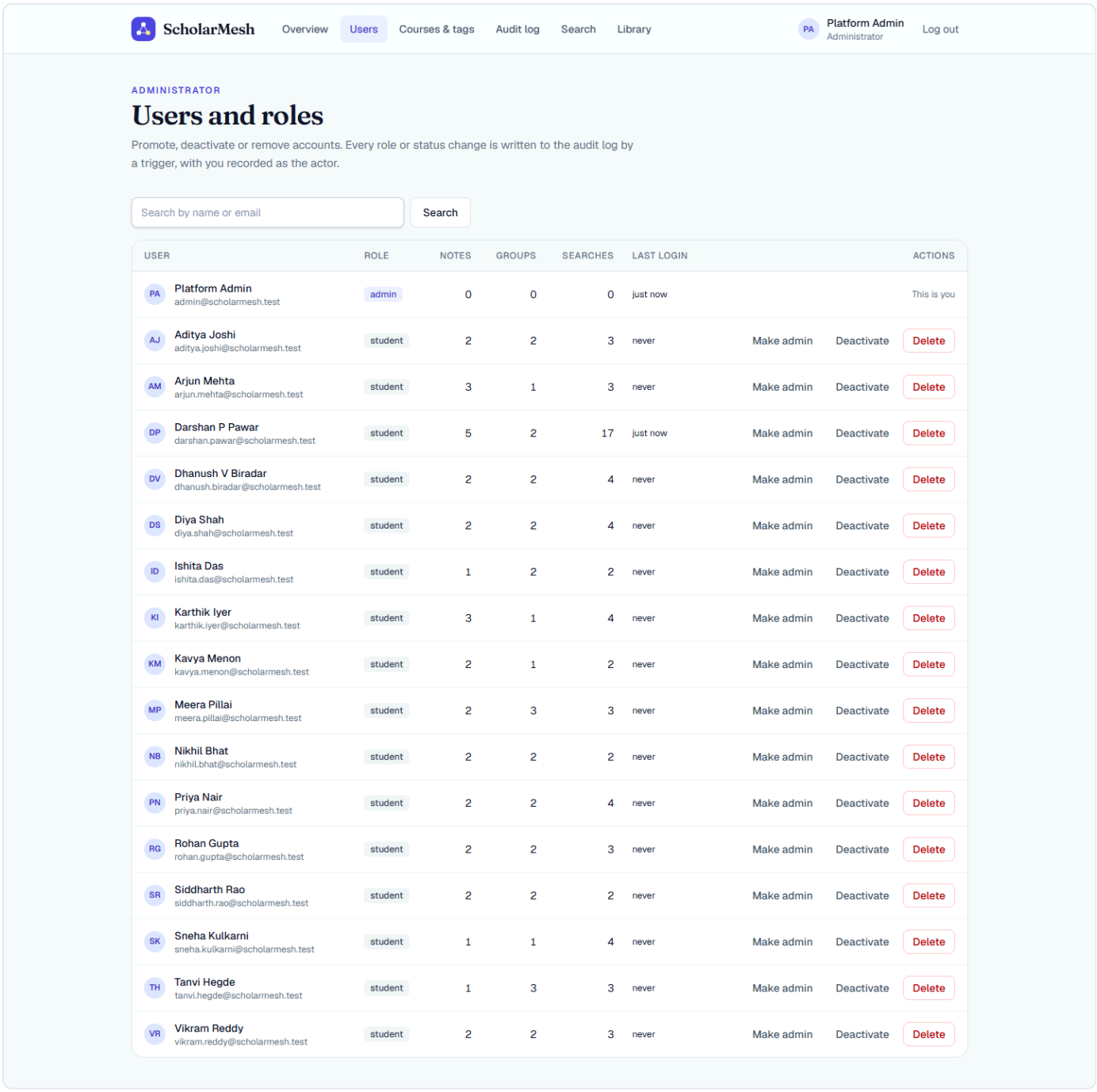


Figure 17 — Admin — users, roles and activation

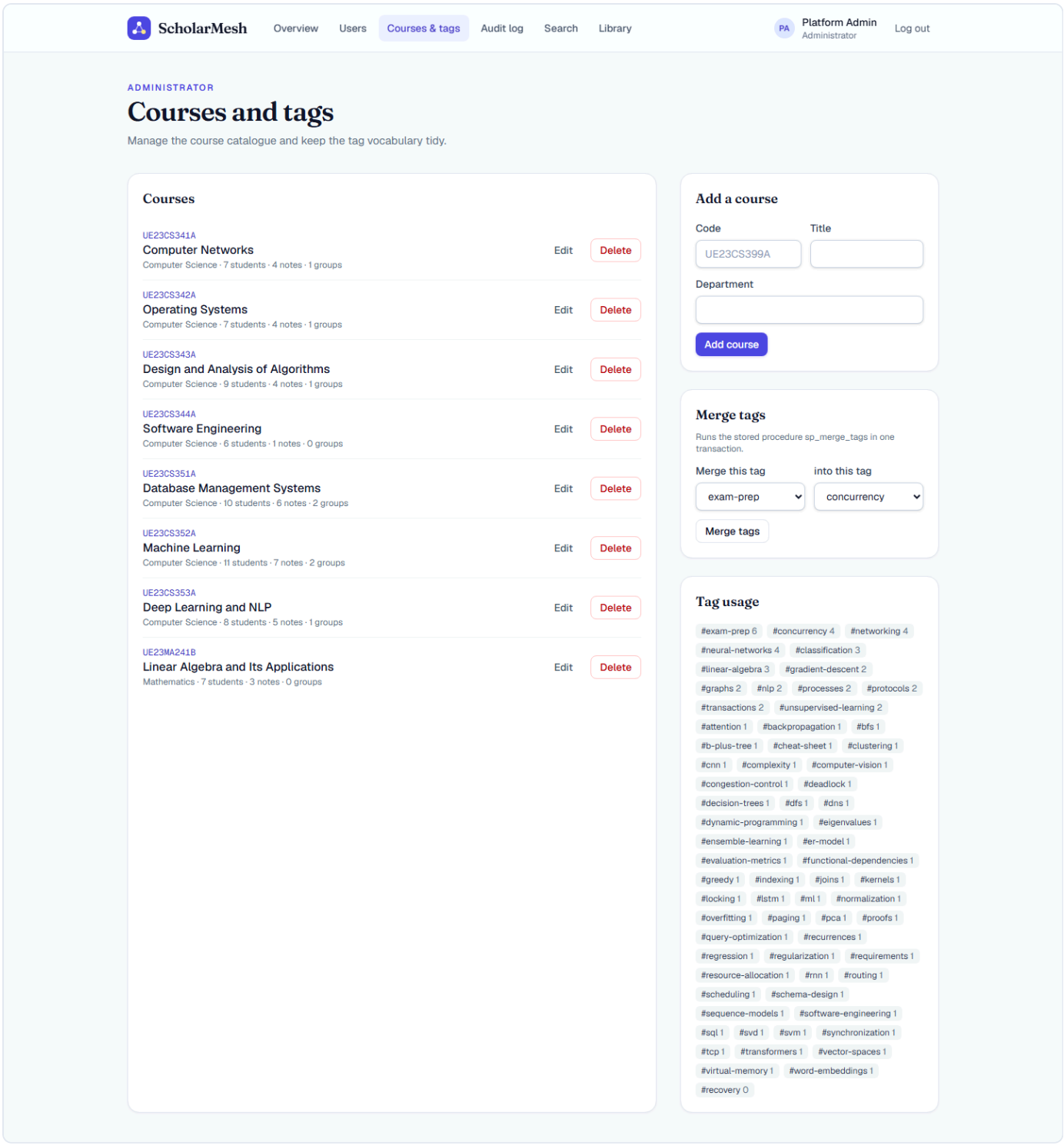


Figure 18 — Admin — course catalogue and tag merge (stored procedure)

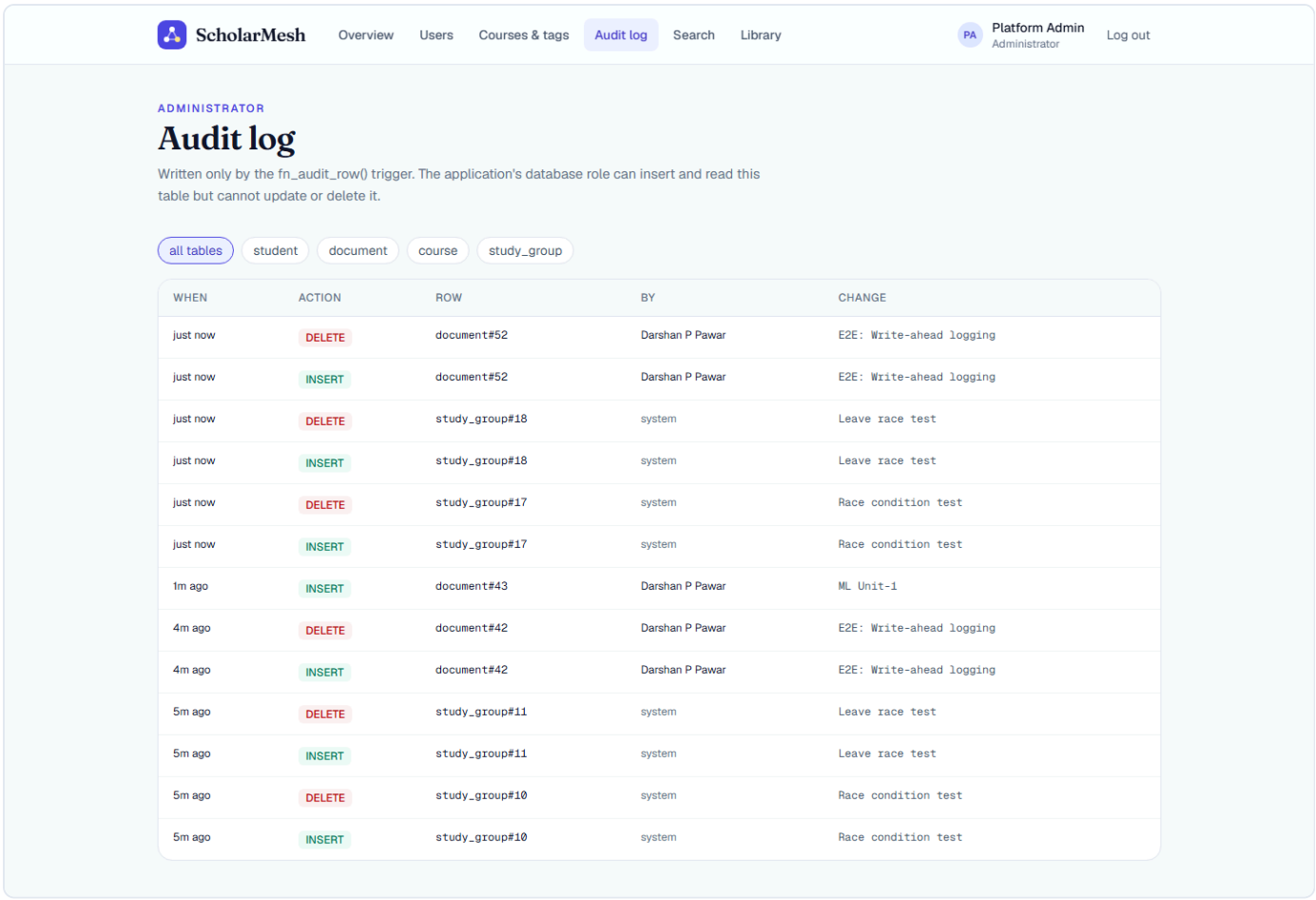


Figure 19 — Admin — audit log written by triggers, with the acting user

16. Testing

101/101	47	44	10
tests passed	unit	database integration	end-to-end

- **Unit tests** (Vitest): input validation, password hashing (the hash satisfies the database CHECK), session tokens (expired, forged and tampered tokens rejected), error mapping, CSRF guard, rate limiter, safe highlighting.
- **Database integration tests** (Vitest + pg) run as the application role against the real database, each inside `BEGIN … ROLLBACK` with savepoints, so they can assert that a statement *fails* with the right SQLSTATE and leave no data behind. They cover constraints, every trigger, access control, the three search modes, recommendations, procedures, privileges and a real two-connection race for the last seat.
- **End-to-end tests** (Playwright, Chromium) drive the production build: login, semantic and keyword search, privacy of other students' notes, upload and delete, the full-group rule, admin-only pages.
- Also checked: TypeScript strict type-check, ESLint, production build, and the SQL demonstration script (only the intended "group is full" error).
- **Independent code and security review** of the finished code: 15 distinct findings (redirect loop for stale sessions, private-note metadata in tag counts and recommendations, a leave race, upload limits, rate-limit spoofing, open redirect, …). All were fixed and covered by new tests, except open self-enrollment, which is documented as a limitation (§3).

Commands: `npm test`, `npm run test:e2e`, `npm run typecheck`, `npm run lint` (in `web/`).

#	Layer	Test case	Result
1	Database integration	STUDENT constraints › rejects an invalid email (chk_student_email)	passed
2	Database integration	STUDENT constraints › rejects a plain-text password (chk_student_pwd_bcrypt)	passed
3	Database integration	STUDENT constraints › email uniqueness ignores case and whitespace (unique index + normalise trigger)	passed
4	Database integration	STUDENT constraints › role and year_of_study are restricted	passed
5	Database integration	DOCUMENT constraints › course-only visibility requires a course (chk_document_course_vis)	passed
6	Database integration	DOCUMENT constraints › file type and visibility are whitelisted	passed
7	Database integration	DOCUMENT constraints › a document must belong to an existing student (foreign key)	passed
8	Database integration	other tables › semester format, duplicate enrollment, tag format, group size	passed
9	Database integration	other tables › tag names are normalised by trigger before the CHECK runs	passed
10	Database integration	other tables › group names are unique per course	passed
11	Database integration	access control (fn_visible_doc_ids) › another student's private note is invisible; your own is visible	passed
12	Database integration	access control (fn_visible_doc_ids) › course-only notes are visible to enrolled students only	passed
13	Database integration	access control (fn_visible_doc_ids) › admins see every document	passed
14	Database integration	access control (fn_visible_doc_ids) › search never returns a document the student cannot see	passed
15	Database integration	search functions › keyword search finds exact terms and returns highlight markers	passed
16	Database integration	search functions › semantic search ranks a document first for its own passage (similarity ≈ 1)	passed

#	Layer	Test case	Result
17	Database integration	search functions › hybrid search fuses both rankings (RRF)	passed
18	Database integration	search functions › course and tag filters narrow every search	passed
19	Database integration	search functions › fn_chunk_text never exceeds the limit and keeps every word	passed
20	Database integration	recommendations › only open groups in the student's courses that they have not joined	passed
21	Database integration	recommendations › private notes never shape what other students are shown	passed
22	Database integration	recommendations › study partners share at least one course	passed
23	Database integration	stored procedures › sp_join_group adds a member and rejects a duplicate (SM409)	passed
24	Database integration	stored procedures › sp_merge_tags re-points documents and removes the old tag	passed
25	Database integration	least-privilege application role › cannot drop or alter tables	passed
26	Database integration	least-privilege application role › can append to the audit log but never edit or erase it	passed
27	Database integration	least-privilege application role › can refresh the materialized view only through the SECURITY DEFINER function	passed
28	Database integration	transactions › a failing statement rolls back the whole unit of work	passed
29	Database integration	transactions › two students racing for the last seat: exactly one gets it	passed
30	Database integration	transactions › the last two members leaving at the same moment never leave an orphan group	passed
31	Database integration	document triggers › T4 splits content into chunks and T3 marks the document pending	passed
32	Database integration	document triggers › editing content re-chunks; editing only the title does not	passed
33	Database integration	document triggers › bookkeeping updates (embedding status) do not change 'last edited'	passed
34	Database integration	document triggers › deleting a course turns its course-only notes private instead of failing	passed
35	Database integration	study-group triggers › T6 makes the creator the group admin	passed
36	Database integration	study-group triggers › T5 refuses a member who is not enrolled in the course (SM002)	passed
37	Database integration	study-group triggers › T5 refuses to overfill a group (SM001)	passed
38	Database integration	study-group triggers › T8 blocks demoting the last admin (SM003)	passed
39	Database integration	study-group triggers › T7 promotes the longest-standing member when the admin leaves	passed
40	Database integration	study-group triggers › T7 deletes a group when its last member leaves	passed
41	Database integration	study-group triggers › deleting the creator's account keeps the group (created_by SET NULL)	passed
42	Database integration	study-group triggers › T9 blocks shrinking max_members below the member count (SM004)	passed
43	Database integration	study-group triggers › T10 dropping a course also leaves its study groups	passed
44	Database integration	audit trigger (T11) › records the acting user from app.current_user_id and strips secrets	passed
45	Unit	password hashing › produces a bcrypt hash the database CHECK accepts	passed
46	Unit	password hashing › verifies the right password and rejects a wrong one	passed
47	Unit	password hashing › hashes are salted (same input, different hash)	passed
48	Unit	session tokens › round-trips user id and role	passed
49	Unit	session tokens › rejects a token signed with another secret	passed
50	Unit	session tokens › rejects a tampered token (role escalation attempt)	passed
51	Unit	session tokens › rejects an expired token	passed
52	Unit	session tokens › rejects missing or garbage tokens and unknown roles	passed
53	Unit	toErrorResponse › ApiError keeps its status and message	passed

#	Layer	Test case	Result
54	Unit	toErrorResponse › ZodError becomes 400 with per-field messages	passed
55	Unit	toErrorResponse › maps PostgreSQL error { code: '23505', …(1) }	passed
56	Unit	toErrorResponse › maps PostgreSQL error { code: '23514', …(1) }	passed
57	Unit	toErrorResponse › maps PostgreSQL error { code: '23503' }	passed
58	Unit	toErrorResponse › maps PostgreSQL error { code: 'SM001', …(1) }	passed
59	Unit	toErrorResponse › maps PostgreSQL error { code: 'SM002', …(1) }	passed
60	Unit	toErrorResponse › unknown errors become a generic 500 without internals	passed
61	Unit	request guards › cross-site mutation is blocked, same-site and GET are allowed	passed
62	Unit	request guards › parseId accepts positive integers only	passed
63	Unit	request guards › readJson rejects invalid JSON and non-objects	passed
64	Unit	format helpers › highlightParts turns ts_headline markers into safe parts (no HTML)	passed
65	Unit	format helpers › timeAgo and formatBytes	passed
66	Unit	rateLimit › allows the limit, then answers 429 until the window resets	passed
67	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › /groups/3 -> /groups/3	passed
68	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › /search?q=bcnf -> /search?q=bcnf	passed
69	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › //evil.com -> /dashboard	passed
70	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › /\evil.com -> /dashboard	passed
71	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › /%5Cevil.com -> /%5Cevil.com	passed
72	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › https://evil.com/login -> /dashboard	passed
73	Unit	safeNextPath (post-login redirect) › javascript:alert(1) -> /dashboard	passed
74	Unit	registerSchema › accepts a valid student and normalises the email	passed
75	Unit	registerSchema › rejects weak password short	passed
76	Unit	registerSchema › rejects weak password onlyletters	passed
77	Unit	registerSchema › rejects weak password 12345678	passed
78	Unit	registerSchema › rejects a bad email and a one-letter name	passed
79	Unit	registerSchema › rejects a year of study outside 1-6	passed
80	Unit	loginSchema › requires a password	passed
81	Unit	documentMetaSchema › turns an empty course into null	passed
82	Unit	documentMetaSchema › course-only visibility needs a course	passed
83	Unit	documentMetaSchema › rejects unknown visibility and short titles	passed
84	Unit	documentMetaSchema › caps the number of tags at 8	passed
85	Unit	splitTags › splits, trims, lower-cases, hyphenates and de-duplicates	passed
86	Unit	splitTags › returns [] for non-strings	passed
87	Unit	other schemas › semester must look like 2026-ODD	passed
88	Unit	other schemas › group size must be 2-20	passed
89	Unit	other schemas › course codes are upper-cased and checked	passed
90	Unit	other schemas › search defaults to hybrid and needs 2+ characters	passed

#	Layer	Test case	Result
91	Unit	tag normalisation › array tags with spaces are hyphenated and de-duplicated like the database trigger does	passed
92	End-to-end (Chromium)	anonymous visitors are sent to the login page	passed
93	End-to-end (Chromium)	wrong password shows an error	passed
94	End-to-end (Chromium)	admin sees the platform overview and the audit log	passed
95	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › dashboard shows stats, feed and recommendations	passed
96	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › semantic search finds a note with no shared keywords	passed
97	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › keyword search highlights the matched term	passed
98	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › another student's private note is not reachable	passed
99	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › upload a note by pasting text, then delete it	passed
100	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › a full study group refuses another member	passed
101	End-to-end (Chromium)	student journey › students cannot open admin pages	passed

17. Requirement coverage

Requirement (project brief)	Evidence
Meaningful problem, beyond CRUD	§1; semantic retrieval, matching, DB-enforced rules
SQL + vector database (Option 2), justified	PostgreSQL 17 + pgvector; §8
ER diagram → relational schema; entities, attributes, PK, FK, relationships, constraints	§6, §7, §9
Vector component: data model, embeddings, metadata, indexes, retrieval strategy	§11
DDL: CREATE, ALTER, DROP, keys, constraints, indexes, views	§10.1–10.4, `db/01–03`
DML: INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE, SELECT with JOIN, GROUP BY, HAVING, ORDER BY, aggregates, subqueries	§13 Q1–Q14; the app's repositories
≥ 4 advanced features	§12 (11 listed)
Next.js interface with forms, tables, search, filtering, dashboards	§15
Backend/API layer; no hard-coded credentials; environment variables	§14; `.env.example` files
Authentication and ≥ 2 roles	student / admin (+ group admin / member); §4
Validation at database level; consistency and integrity	§10.2, §10.6, §10.7; tests in §16
Security: no plain-text passwords or credentials	bcrypt + CHECK; §10.8, §14

Requirement (project brief)	Evidence
Documentation, testing results, screenshots	This report; README
Git/GitHub with individual commits; README	§18; `README.md`

18. Individual contributions and version control

Both members worked on the database and on the application, as the brief requires. Each owned one end-to-end slice — **notes and search** (Darshan) and **people, groups and administration** (Dhanush) — and reviewed the other's work.

Member	Database work	Application work
Darshan P Pawar PES2UG24CS143	• Phase 1 ER diagram, schema and DDL; Phase 1 review and fixes (§5) • Phase 2 schema evolution (`ALTER` s, DOC_CHUNK, AUDIT_LOG, CHECK constraints, indexes) • pgvector set-up, HNSW and GIN indexes, chunking function and document triggers (T3, T4) • Keyword, semantic and hybrid search functions; similarity threshold calibration • Seed data (courses, students, 33 study notes)	• Upload pipeline (PDF/text extraction, one-transaction save, embedding worker) • Search page, library, note detail and upload pages • Database setup script and embedding job • Report, ER and architecture diagrams, screenshots
Dhanush V Biradar PES2UG24CS155	• Views and the materialized view; interest-profile view • Study-group triggers (seat limit, creator admin, succession, guards) and procedures `sp_join_group` , `sp_leave_group` , `sp_merge_tags` • Recommendation functions (groups and partners) • Audit trigger, least-privilege app role and grants • Important-queries script (§13) and EXPLAIN analysis	• Authentication, sessions, roles and the proxy gate; security hardening • API layer: validation, error mapping, CSRF check, rate limiting • Dashboard, study groups, courses and all admin pages (charts, users, audit log) • Automated tests: unit, database integration and Playwright end-to-end

Repository: `https://github.com/Darshanpawar7/DBMS-Mini-Project` . It contains `db/` (SQL), `web/` (Next.js app and tests) and `docs/` (this report, diagrams, screenshots). Each member commits their own work from their own GitHub account (feature branches merged by pull request), so the history shows individual contributions. Setup and run instructions are in `README.md` .

19. Conclusion and future enhancements

ScholarMesh shows how one PostgreSQL database can serve two paradigms at once: a strictly validated relational model for people, courses, groups and activity, and a vector store for meaning-based retrieval — joined in single SQL statements so that access control, ranking and integrity are guaranteed by the database rather than by application code. Phase 1's design was corrected (redundant and missing indexes, a dangling vector pointer, a destructive cascade, missing roles and rules) and extended with chunk-level embeddings, full-text search, views, a materialized view, stored functions and procedures, triggers, an audit trail and a least-privilege application role. A Next.js application exposes all of it through a validated API, and 101 automated tests confirm the behaviour, including real races for the last seat in a group and for leaving one.

Future enhancements

- **OCR** for scanned PDFs and handwritten notes; image and diagram embeddings.
- **Verified enrollment** — sync `ENROLLMENT` from the university system, or require a per-course join code.
- **Row-Level Security** policies so the access rule is enforced even for ad-hoc SQL, not only through the functions.
- **Background job queue** (e.g. a worker table polled with `SELECT … FOR UPDATE SKIP LOCKED`) for large uploads.
- **Re-ranking** the top hybrid results with a cross-encoder; per-course embedding fine-tuning.
- **Notifications** when a recommended group has a free seat; meeting scheduling inside groups.
- **Table partitioning** of `SEARCH_LOG` and `AUDIT_LOG` by month as they grow; a Redis-backed rate limiter for multiple servers.

Appendix A — Running the project

```
cp .env.example .env                 # choose database passwords
docker compose up -d                 # PostgreSQL 17 + pgvector on port 5433
cd web && cp .env.example .env.local # DATABASE_URL (app password) + AUTH_SECRET
npm install
npm run db:setup                     # schema, functions, triggers, grants, seed data
npm run db:embed                     # compute embeddings (downloads the 23 MB model once)
npm run dev                          # http://localhost:3000
```

Demo logins: `darshan.pawar@scholarmesh.test` and `dhanush.biradar@scholarmesh.test` (students, password `Scholar@123`); `admin@scholarmesh.test / Admin@12345` (admin).